

Errata & Revisions

A reverse-chronological list of prior assertions on this site that have been revised, corrected, or withdrawn. Each entry names the original claim, the corrected reading, and the evidence that prompted the revision. The Confirmed / Working / Open / Eliminated taxonomy elsewhere on the site is the live state of the work; this page is its history.

Genealogical claims revise. The nine-attestation surname trail recorded here was not assembled in a single sitting — it is the survival, after thirteen candidate families and several mistaken readings, of what remained when each new piece of evidence was confronted with the prior interpretation. We list the revisions formally so that anyone citing an earlier version of this site, an earlier email from one of the authors, or an earlier Family Tree pull-down can locate the change and the warrant.

Entries are tagged **MAJOR** when the revision changes a public-facing conclusion, **MINOR** when it corrects a transcription, date, or attribution, and **WITHDRAWN** when a hypothesis was retired without a replacement.

MODERATE 21 June 2026 · surname-canon expansion · the surname trail grows from eight attestations to nine with the 1895 Gould’s St. Louis city-directory *Gannsen*

The single-source surname canon (`data/surname-attestations.json`) gains a **ninth attestation — the **1895 Gould’s St. Louis Directory** entry “Gannsen Charles, watchmaker, r. rear 2407 DeKalb,” confirmed in-image. Every count, table, figure, and metric derived from the canon was regenerated; the **Konzen Puzzle** ([germany/konzen-puzzle.html](#)) trail, chronology, phonetic split, and trail figure now read **nine**.**

BEFORE

The surname trail was fixed at **eight** distinct American spellings across eight attestations, 1866–1896 (canon last set 17 May 2026 with the 1890 Konzen z-form re-reading). The namesake form Gannsen was treated only as Charles’s own holograph (1862 enlistment, 1868 naturalization, 1890–91 pension) and not counted within the 1866–1896 trail.

AFTER

The 1895 Gould’s directory listing (FamilySearch Full-Text, ark 3QHV-V38V-568N, image 268) places Gannsen **inside** the 1866–1896 window, supplied to a secular canvasser rather than a pastor — an [a]-vowel, G-stem **outlier** alongside the 1870 Gansen baptism — and surfaces the first trace of a **son, Charles Jr.** (laborer, same address). Counts move **eight → nine** spellings / attestations and **two → three** outliers (the cluster stays at six: three [ˈkɒn.sən], three [ˈɡɒn.sən]); the canonical trail order is now

Gonnson · Gansen · Gonsen · Konsen · Gonson · Jansen · Konzen · **Gannsen** · Conson. The deploy-gate canon guard (`scripts/check_surname_canon.py`) was updated to the nine-count and re-run clean across the site.

Source: Gould’s St. Louis Directory 1895 (FamilySearch Full-Text ark 3QHV-V38V-568N, img 268); `Session105_BrightData_Nimble_Setup_Kassel_Archive_June21_2026.md`; canon source `data/surname-attestations.json`.

WITHDRAWN 21 June 2026 · candidate retraction · the new “Carl” candidate Carl Wilhelm Konze (b. 1831) is eliminated by his documented 1869 Trendelburg death

The candidate surfaced earlier the same day — Carl Wilhelm Konze (b. 15 Sep 1831) — is eliminated. An exhaustive cross-check against the project’s own Archion-sourced master tree shows he died at Trendelburg on 30 October 1869, having married and raised a family there. Justus Ernst Konze (b. 1829) is once again the sole Konze male of Charles’s generation with no provable German death or emigration.

BEFORE

The FamilySearch-tree reconciliation earlier on 21 June added **Carl Wilhelm Konze** (FS 99Z3-DFK) as a “strong secondary lead pending Archion verification” — attractive because his given name is literally “Carl,” his FS stub carried zero sources, and he appeared to vanish from the Trendelburg record after baptism.

AFTER

Verification against the project master tree (Sessions 18 & 21, from the Archion Trendelburg register) shows the FS stub was simply incomplete, not evidence of disappearance: **Carl Wilhelm Konze married Marie Lauterbach (of Deisel), fathered a son Karl (b. 1857), and died at Trendelburg 30 October 1869** — corroborated independently by the son’s 1882 marriage record naming Carl Wilhelm × Marie Lauterbach as parents (FS Germany Marriages, MPCF-4M9). He stayed in Trendelburg his whole life and is therefore **not Charles**. The **abstract** ([abstract.html](#)), **claims dashboard** ([claims-dashboard.html](#)), and **negative-results audit** ([negative-results.html#families](#)) now carry the elimination; **Justus Ernst Konze (P87Z-ZDC)** remains the only cohort male whose German death/emigration cannot be shown, decided by the two offline tests — the un-indexed Stammen burial register (Archion 220072) and an HStAM Bestand 180 Hofgeismar emigration/release file. Lesson logged: an empty FamilySearch stub (“Deceased / no date / 0 sources”) must not be read as “vanished.”

Source: [FS_Tree_Konze_Reconciliation_June21_2026.md](#) §7 (correction);

[Kontze_Family_Tree_and_Research_Paths.md](#) (Sessions 18 & 21, Archion Trendelburg register); FS Germany Marriages [MPCF-4M9](#) .

MODERATE 21 June 2026 · identity resolution & candidate addition · the FamilySearch shared Tree fixes Identity 4's parent generation and Anna Christina Konze's father, and surfaces a new "Carl" candidate

A register-sourced FamilySearch Tree reconstruction of the Deisel/Trendelburg Konze clan identifies the father of Identity 4 (Andreas 1795) and of Anna Christina Konze as one man — making them siblings — and adds Carl Wilhelm Konze (b. 1831) to the candidate pool for Charles.

BEFORE

The Konze disentanglement left **Anna Christina Konze** (m. Carl Wilhelm Hofedietz, 1820) with a father "no longer securely identified," and carried **Identity 4** (Andreas, b. 1 Oct 1795 × Hofeditz) with his father recorded only as "Friedrich Konze × Dorothee Elisabeth Jordan," undated. The Charles candidate roster turned on **Justus Ernst Konze** (b. 1829) as the lone surviving son who vanishes.

AFTER

The FS Tree places both as children of **Johann Friedrich Kontze (FS 99Z3-6H9, 1763–1823) × Dorothee Elisabeth Jordan (99Z3-6HX, b. 1766)**: Anna Christina (PH2M-FGY, b. 11 Dec 1800, d. 1852 Sielen), Ludwig Karl (99Z3-DXR, 1804–1862), and Andreas 1795 (PZF8-X19, d. 6 Oct 1854 Mainz) — so **Anna Christina is a full sister of Identity 4** and his father is the dated **Joh. Friedrich Kontze 1763**. A **new candidate** emerges: **Carl Wilhelm Konze (FS 99Z3-DFK), b. 15 Sep 1831 Trendelburg**, son of Ludwig Karl (1804) × Wilhelmine Marie Albrecht — a **first cousin of Justus Ernst** who carries no death, marriage, children, or sources in FS and disappears from the Trendelburg record after baptism. His given name "Carl" is a closer fit to Charles's reconstructed name than "Justus Ernst." Justus Ernst (P87Z-ZDC, b. 1829) is independently corroborated as the only other son who vanishes, but remains ~5–6 years off Charles's stated 1835. Charles himself appears as **"Carl Konzen" (LZXK-6GB), b. 26 Jan 1835, no parents attached**. Held as a strong secondary lead pending Archion verification — the FS Tree is collaborative/user-built, so key edges are checked against the original register before being treated as proven.

Source: FamilySearch shared Family Tree, cross-read 21 Jun 2026 against

`Andreas_Konze_Identity_Disentanglement.md` and Peter Schröder's reconstruction —

`FS_Tree_Konze_Reconciliation_June21_2026.md`.

VERIFIED 21 June 2026 · citation audit · every Archion register/Seite/image locator across the site checked – no errors found

A full audit of the site's Archion citations — 236 locators across 22 registers and 21 files — against the live registers found zero citation errors. No correction was required; this entry records the verification.

BEFORE

The site's 236 Archion locators (register + Seite + image) had accumulated across ~100 sessions and had never been systematically cross-checked for transposed page/image numbers in one pass.

AFTER

A programmatic consistency scan of the 118 cross-checkable Seite+image pairs raised **21 apparent flags, every one of which resolved to a non-error** — either regex artifacts where a table cell lists two registers together, or legitimate multi-section pagination (combined baptism/marriage/burial books restart page numbering at 1). Live verification in the Archion viewer confirmed register **22096** (the surname-conclusion register) at **eight anchor points across all three sections**, each an exact Seite ↔ image match. **No site text was changed.**

Source: `Archion_Citation_Audit_June21_2026.md` — programmatic scan of served HTML plus live reads in the Archion viewer (signed in as Jed Johnson), 21 Jun 2026.

MINOR 21 June 2026 · new leads / negative findings · StLGS untapped-resource sweep and the widened “any Carl” Tier-1 search

Two follow-up searches: the StLGS untapped-resource sweep returns one low-confidence new lead (a “Conson” probate entry) against otherwise clean negatives, and the surname-open Tier-1 “any Carl, 1833–1841” re-scan is opened (in progress).

BEFORE

Several StLGS databases (the 1804–1876 probate index, Globe-Democrat death index, two funeral homes, First Families, four-generation charts) had not been searched for the family's surname variants. The German-side candidate search had been filtered to the **Konze surname pool** only.

AFTER

The StLGS sweep (positive-controlled, so the zeros are true negatives) is **negative across every database except one low-confidence hit: “Conson, James & Sophie,” 1804–1876 Index to Probate Abstracts, vol 1 p 30** — “Conson” being a documented spelling of the family, though also a generic surname; Charles (d. 1903) and Augusta (d. 1896) fall outside this index's date range. Separately, a **Tier-1 re-scan with widened criteria** (any male Carl/Karl, surname open, legitimate or illegitimate, 1833–1841, both confessions) is opened: because Deisel's registers gap 1831–1858, its 1833–1841 baptisms sit in the Trendelburg book (218842); the search pivots to confirmation registers first, with the core Deisel classes 1847–1853 (births ~1833–1839) **queued for Archion transcription — not yet read**. No prior conclusion is revised; this records the leads and open threads.

Sources: `Session_StLGS_Untapped_Resources_Sweep_June21_2026.md` ; `Tier1_Search_Log_June2026.md` .

MODERATE 19 June 2026 · transcription / image mismatch · the “Doc 0” source page transcribed the wrong card – its Age field is blank

The Military Record (Doc 0) (<sources/military-record.html>) page transcribed “age 23,” “Company G,” and “Freundburg, Kurhessen” — but the image actually displayed is a Missouri AGO service-abstract card whose **Age field is blank** and which names no birthplace. The age and birthplace are on the **Regimental Descriptive Book card (Card 2)**.

BEFORE

The Doc 0 page presented its PDF as the “Freundburg, Kurhessen” enlistment card and transcribed: rank Private, Company G, age at enlistment 23 years, place of birth “Freundburg, Kurhessen.”

AFTER

The displayed PDF is a Missouri Adjutant-General's Office abstract card (Form No. 242, heading “2d (New) Reg't Art. Vols.”) for “Gunnsen, Chas. L. or Gannsen, Chas.”: **Age blank; Sergeant, Co. B** (Capt. Sutter); enlisted 2 Dec 1862, St. Louis; Remarks “Pro. Sergt. from Corp. Nov 7, 1863. Reduced to ranks March 15, 1865”; mustered out 20 Dec 1865. The transcription and framing have been corrected, and the “age 23” / “Freundburg, Kurhessen” data are now attributed to the **Regimental Descriptive Book card (Card 2)** (<evidence/card-2-civil-war-enlistment.html>), where they actually appear. The **birth-date reference page** (<birthdate-records.html>) sources the “age 23 → ~1839” data point to Card 2 accordingly.

Source: original card images re-read 19 Jun 2026 — [Charles Gannsen military record.pdf](#) (AGO card) vs. [evidence_images/evidence_1_civil_war.jpg](#) (Descriptive Book card).

MODERATE 19 June 2026 · source-attribution & transcription corrections · the 26 Jan 1835 date is from the burial register, not the pension; Original Invalid Pension declaration re-dated 15 Jan 1890

The canonical 26 January 1835 birth date was credited in two places to Charles's "pension affidavit." The pension file gives only ages; the full date is from the St. Marcus burial register (Doc N, entry no. 3393). Separately, the Original Invalid Pension declaration is re-dated 15 January 1890 (not 16), with Charles's age reading mid-50s (~56), not 53.

BEFORE

The [life-timeline](#) ([charles_america/life-timeline.html](#)) and a Key-Evidence pointer on the home page stated the 26 Jan 1835 date came "from his Civil War pension affidavit." The pension-file page ([sources/pension-file.html#p14](#)) dated the Original Invalid Pension declaration "16 January 1890", transcribed Charles's age as "53," and read the certifying officer as "Capt. J. J. Setzer."

AFTER

Attribution corrected: the day and month are from the [St. Marcus burial register #3393](#) (Doc N); the pension yields only inconsistent self-reported ages. Re-examination of the original scan re-dates the declaration to [15 January 1890](#), sworn before Circuit Court Clerk [Philip H. Zepp](#) (the name already correctly read on the verso, PG 15), with Charles's age in the [mid-50s \(~56\)](#) → implied birth ~1833-34. A new reference page, Charles's birth date across the U.S. records ([birthdate-records.html](#)) (Docs A, B, D, M, N, O), now collates and ranks every U.S. record under the Genealogical Proof Standard and the Mills evidence-analysis model.

Source: NARA pension file F41-523680269E, declaration pages re-read 19 Jun 2026; 2020 AncestryProGenealogists journal appendix (Doc A-O). See [changelog](#) ([changelog.html#cl-2026-06-19-birthdate-records](#)).

MODERATE 8 June 2026 · identity split · Deisel had TWO Johann Christoph Konze men – the Bürgermeister's "two wives" were two husbands

The census gave Bürgermeister Christoph Konze two wives (Hillebrand and Schrage) with overlapping child-years. The 1808 baptisms prove these are two distinct Johann Christoph Konze men.

BEFORE

Bürgermeister Christoph Konze (b. 1784) was shown with ×1 Anna Margaretha Hillebrand and ×2 Maria Elisabeth Schrage, fathering children by both 1806–1825 (the overlap was flagged as suspicious).

AFTER

Two Deisel baptisms of 1808 settle it: **Christian Kontze (b. 6 Aug 1808), father Joh. Christoph × Maria Elisabeth Schrage** (Fol. 55); and **Johann Christoph Kontze (b. 1 Oct 1808), father Joh. Christoph × Anna Margaretha Hillebrand** (Fol. 57) — two men of the same name fathering sons two months apart. The **Bürgermeister (son of Christian, b. 1784) = the × Schrage man** (children Christian, Wilhelmine, Ludwig, Catharina Elisabeth, Amalie, Maria, Philipp #1, Louise Amalia). The **× Hillebrand man is separate** (children Andreas 1806–83, Joh. Christoph "II" 1808–60, Anna Catharina 1811, Charlotte 1814–59). The by-town page now lists them as two rows.

Source: 218824 Fol. 55 (img 1679) & Fol. 57 (img 1680), max-zoom read 8 Jun 2026. See changelog (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-08-followups).

MINOR 8 June 2026 · transcription corrections · two Deisel son-in-law surnames misread

Charlotte Konze's husband is Kloppmann (not Heggemann); Amalie Konze's husband is Sasse (not Paffe) — both confirmed at max zoom, each is ONE man.

BEFORE

Charlotte Konze (b. 1814) × "Adam Heggemann" 1838, with a conflicting "Kloppmann" at her 1859 burial. Amalie Konze (b. 1818) × "Johannes Paffe" 1837, with a conflicting "Sasse" at her 1845 burial — both flagged as possible two-spouse / two-person confusions.

AFTER

Re-read of the 1838 marriage (218860 E90) shows the groom is **Adam Kloppmann**, son of Jost Kloppmann × Anna Katharina Böse — "Heggemann" was a misread of the Kl-o-pp letterforms; one husband. Re-read of the 1837 marriage (218860 E82) shows the groom is **Johannes Sasse**, son of Ludwig Sasse — "Paffe" was a misread of the capital S; one husband. Each woman married once; no duplicate persons.

Sources: 218860 E90 (img 1319), E82 (img 1317); 218851 E1021, E465. See changelog (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-08-followups).

WITHDRAWN 8 June 2026 · candidate retraction · the Friedrichsfeld “[?]ard Kontze” colonist (roster A), the “Konze women behind the child” roster (B), and Heinrich Wilhelm (roster C)

The “wider candidate field” rosters A and B both rested on one disputed baptism. The project’s complete Friedrichsfeld search reads it cleanly as **Maria Sabina Kontze (b. 1834), infant daughter of Andreas Kontze × Maria Sophia née Hofeditz** — there is no “[?]ard colonist” and no unread Konze mother. Roster C’s Heinrich Wilhelm is also eliminated.

BEFORE

Roster A held the “[?]ard Kontze, Colonist” as a possible fourth Konze father (flagged “probably spurious” since 31 May 2026). **Roster B** listed Konze women who might stand behind the “Entry 28” child on the theory that the mother’s maiden name was an unread Konze surname. **Roster C** carried **Heinrich Wilhelm Konze** (b. 1832) as inconclusive (“untraced after the family scattered 1843–46”).

AFTER

The complete page-by-page Friedrichsfeld baptism search (9 April 2026) reads “Entry 28” as **Maria Sabina Kontze, b. 10 Jan 1834, d. 18 Feb 1834**, daughter of **Andreas Kontze, Colonist (gebürtig von Trendelburg)**, × **Maria Sophia née Hofeditz**. Session 22’s “Maria Catharina / [?]ard Kontze / Jan 1835 / von Friedrichsfeld” is a four-way misread of that single line. **Roster A is retracted** (“[?]ard” = Andreas; no fourth colonist) and **roster B dissolves** (the mother is Hofeditz, not a Konze). **Heinrich Wilhelm is eliminated**: the margin of his own baptism plus the Schröder Stammtafel show he died in Germany 19 Feb 1858, so he never emigrated. Only **Justus Ernst Konze** (b. 1829) remains open, and weakly (siblings die at Stammen, he does not; no marriage/death/emigration record; 1829 birth six years off Charles’s 1835). The candidate tree was recounted to **eight men — six eliminated, two inconclusive**, the colonist card marked withdrawn.

Sources: [Friedrichsfeld_KB_Complete_Baptism_Search_1830-1836_April9_2026.md](#) (Entry 28 = Maria Sabina); [Konfirmationen_Search_Results_April5_2026.md](#) and

[Konze_Family_Census_By_Location_June6_2026.md](#) (Heinrich Wilhelm d. 1858; the siblings at Stammen).

Files: [germany/konzen-puzzle.html](#), [assets/figures/konzen-candidate-tree.svg](#). Supersedes [er-2026-05-31-friedrichsfeld-colonist](#). Logged at [changelog](#) · 8 June 2026 ([changelog.html#cl-2026-06-08-wider-candidate-field](#)).

MINOR 8 June 2026 · non-existent-record correction · the “St. Marcus pre-1866 membership roll” cited for hypothesis 4

The Konzen-puzzle page cited a St. Marcus pre-1866 membership roll as a way to test the chosen-name hypothesis. No such record exists: the church’s earliest communicant book is a [Register of Communion, 1877–1897](#).

BEFORE

Hypothesis 4 (“chosen name”) and the “Where the answer might come from” panel listed a [St. Marcus pre-1866 membership roll](#) — “not yet examined” — as a record that could carry a “name formerly known as” notation and resolve the surname question.

AFTER

The complete FamilySearch / FHL inventory of St. Marcus records (baptism from 1847, confirmation from 1840, marriage from 1847, burial from 1847) contains [no membership roll before 1877](#); the only communicant book is a [Register of Communion, 1877–1897](#) (FHL roll 1503035) — ~18 years after Charles’s ~1859 arrival, and a list of communicants by date, not birth-origin. The route cannot resolve hypothesis 4. Both references were corrected to drop the roll and retain the Hessian Auswanderer-Beleg ([glossary.html#g-auswanderer-beleg](#)) as the live lead.

Sources: St. Louis County Library St. Marcus record inventory (FHL rolls 1503034–35, 1491823); the four genealogyvillage “Buecher” St. Marcus indexes. **Files:** [germany/konzen-puzzle.html](#). Logged at changelog · 8 June 2026 ([changelog.html#cl-2026-06-08-stmarcus-membership-roll](#)).

Auguste Kreichelt's birth was carried site-wide as the estimate “~1840.” The St. Marcus German Evangelical death register gives her exact birth as 12 May 1847 at Clausthal; she was born 1847, not ~1840.

BEFORE

Auguste Kreichelt's birth read “~1840” (b. ~1840 Clausthal; immigrated 1853 “age ~13”; died 1896 “age 56”), the estimate carried by her FamilySearch profile and reasoned from her ages at the 1866 marriage and 1896 death. The same-day rigor-audit erratum had canonicalised a stray “1842” on [cast.html](#) to this ~1840 reading.

AFTER

Set to **12 May 1847, Clausthal**, with derived figures corrected (immigrated 1853 age ~6; died 1896 age 49; no longer the eldest Kreichelt child). The source is the **St. Marcus German Evangelical death register** (1896 entry: “born 12 May 1847 at Clausthal, Germany”), independently consistent with the St. Louis civil death-register age of 49. Updated across her profile, the home page, the four Kreichelt-relative pages, the Bertha Barbara page, all seven children pages, the interactive tree, the cast page, the FAQ, and the children-index lifeline graphic. (Her FamilySearch profile still shows ~1840 and may be updated separately.)

Sources: St. Marcus Evangelical Church death register, 1896 (Buecher transcription, “Auguste ... born Kreigelt, wife of Carl, born 12 May 1847 at Clausthal”); St. Louis City death register (age 49). Files: [people/auguste-kreichelt.html](#), [index.html](#), [people/georg-kreichelt.html](#), [people/henriette-kreichelt.html](#), [people/august-kreichelt.html](#), [people/carl-kreichelt.html](#), [people/bertha-barbara-kreichelt.html](#), [children/*.html](#), [tree-interactive.html](#), [cast.html](#), [faq.html](#), [charles_america/index.html](#). Logged at [changelog](#) · 8 June 2026 ([changelog.html#cl-2026-06-08-stlgs-fs-family](#)).

MINOR 8 June 2026 · rigor-audit corrections · cross-page contradictions in the family roster, the service-record summary, and two citations

A full-site genealogical-rigor pass corrected a set of cross-page factual contradictions and source-attribution errors: daughter Auguste's death age, wife Auguste's birth year, Bertha's surname framing, the Claims-Dashboard discharge date, the Identity-at-a-glance birth-source attribution, the enlistment unit, and a still-live future-dated citation.

BEFORE

(1) Daughter **Auguste Gonsen**'s death age appeared as "17" ([who/index.html](#)) and "25" ([cast.html](#)) — both against the canonical 18 (b. 4 Mar 1872, d. 1890). (2) Wife **Auguste Kreichelt**'s birth year read "1842" on [cast.html](#) against the canonical ~1840. (3) [who/index.html](#) described **Bertha** as "married into the Jansen line" — but Jansen is her 1881 baptism surname, not a married name. (4) The **Claims Dashboard** gave the Civil-War service as "2 Dec 1862 – 9 Sep 1865; rank Sergeant," against the site-wide 20 Dec 1865 discharge and the documented reduction to Private. (5) The index **Identity-at-a-glance** row sourced the 26 Jan 1835 birth "per pension" and added a "25 January 1835 (church death record)" reading found on no other page. (6) The enlistment unit showed as "Company G" with no reconciliation, and a "**6 December 2026**" future-dated Schröder citation (which an earlier erratum reported corrected to 6 May 2026) was still live on three pages.

AFTER

(1) Set to **age 18** on both pages. (2) Corrected to "**1840 – 1896.**" (3) Reworded to "baptism surname 'Jansen'; later recorded as 'Bertha Johnson.'" (4) Corrected to "**2 Dec 1862 – 20 Dec 1865; highest rank Sergeant (reduced to Private 15 Mar 1865).**" (5) Re-sourced to **St. Marcus burial register #3393 (Doc N)** for day/month and the 1880/1900 censuses for the year — all tracing to Charles's own testimony, held ★ **Working**; the phantom 25 Jan clause removed. (6) The faithful enlistment-card "Company G" reading kept but annotated (all later muster rolls, the CSR, and the pension file read **Battery B**); the future date corrected to **6 May 2026** across card 2, the evidence index, and the homepage.

Sources: [who/index.html](#), [cast.html](#), [children/auguste.html](#), [claims-dashboard.html](#), [index.html](#), [sources/military-record.html](#), [evidence/card-2-civil-war-enlistment.html](#), [evidence-index.html](#). Full pass logged at **changelog · 8 June 2026** ([changelog.html#cl-2026-06-08-rigor-audit](#)); see also the audit report [Charles_Konzen_Genealogy_Rigor_Audit_June8_2026.docx](#).

MINOR 8 June 2026 (evening) · correction · Christian Ludwig Kontze's couple stayed in Stammen — they did NOT leave after 1835

The census said the Kontze×Temme couple “left Stammen after 1835.” The Stammen burial book shows the opposite: **Anne Gertrud died at Stammen Haus Nr. 21 in 1869 with Christian Ludwig still her living husband.**

BEFORE

Because neither spouse was in the Stammen burial index as read in Session 89, we inferred the couple emigrated/relocated after their 1835 stillborn son.

AFTER

The burial register (220072 S.109, E515) records **Anna Gertrude Kontze geborne Temme, “Ehefrau des Tagelöhner Christian Ludwig Kontze,” Haus Nr. 21, b. 18 May 1801, d. 31 Jan 1869.** “Ehefrau” (not widow) proves Christian Ludwig was alive and resident in Stammen in 1869. The couple never left; in ~36 years their only child was the 1835 stillborn. He died 11 Apr 1883 (baptism margin) but is absent from the Stammen burial register 1830–1936 — so he died elsewhere (Hofgeismar civil registration / a neighbouring parish), still to be located.

Also this session: the swineherd Andreas Kontze remarried 5 Jun 1818 as a widower (“Pfundmeister”); Maria Sophia Konße×Müller is 1813; the 1839 Vicksburg “Konntze” is the unrelated Kountze bank family; Philipp Konze #2's baptism is not in Deisel. See changelog (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-08-loose-ends-2) and [Session97...md](#).

MINOR 8 June 2026 · source-conflict resolution · Christian Ludwig Kontze was born in STAMMEN, not Gottsbüren

The 1833 Stammen marriage's “gebürtig von Gottsbüren” is contradicted by Christian Ludwig's own baptism: **b. 20 Nov 1806, bap. 23 Nov 1806, Stammen (KB 220063 img 1988).**

BEFORE

Gottsbüren carried a “claimed, unconfirmed” Konze tie based on the 1833 marriage record; the family's home parish was an open question (“Deisel/Trendelburg suspected”).

AFTER

The swineherd family is Stammen's through and through: married there 1783, twelve children baptized there 1784–1809, both parents buried there (1817, 1828). The father was **Andreas Kontze, son of Arnold Philipp Konze of Trendelburg** — resolving the 1787 “des Vaters Halbbruder” entry (half-brothers via Arnold Philipp's two wives). Gottsbüren's pill changes to “claim refuted”; the one remaining Gottsbüren Konze datum is a Jungkonze-born woman who died there in 1855.

Sources: 220063 imgs 2063 (marriage), 1958–1992 (baptisms), 2121/2131 (burials). See changelog (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-08-swineherd-solved) and [Session96...md](#).

MODERATE 7 June 2026 (late night) · reading corrections · the last four open questions register-resolved (218821, 218824, 218842)

The Küster's marriages found in 218821 (Temme 1739, Guthmann 1773 — “Brandt” fully withdrawn; he d. 21, not 2, Mar 1791); Philipp 1r's baptism re-found and confirmed (b. 20 Nov 1825); Ludwig-1836's parents read in his own baptism (Joh. Christoph Konze × Maria Drönner — not the Bürgermeister); the two Heinrich×Thiele rows merged.

BEFORE

- (1) Andreas Kontze I “the Küster” × “Maria Elisabeth Brandt”, d. 2 Mar 1791. (2) Philipp Konze 1r's birth uncertain (baptism 20 Nov vs marriage-age ~20 Aug 1825). (3) Ludwig Konze (b. 25 Oct 1836, → Frankfurt 1864) attributed to Bürgermeister Christoph Konze × a third wife “Maria Drönner”. (4) Two separate Deisel households “Heinrich Konze × Thiele”.

AFTER

- (1) 218821 verified: ×1 **Elisabetha Temme** m. **23 Feb 1739** (d. 6 Mar 1772), ×2 **Maria Guthmann** m. **12 Feb 1773**; Konrad's 1780 baptism names “Ux. Anna Maria, geb. Gutmaennin”; the Küster d. **21 Mar 1791** (bur. 23 Mar, Nr. 1), and his 1739 marriage names his father: the late **Christoph Cüntz**. (2) The baptism exists (218824, Dezbr. 1825, †-Feb-1872 margin): “geb. d. 20. mens. praet.” = **b. 20 Nov 1825**, parents Konze × Schrage — the 1849 marriage age was simply wrong by three months. (3) Ludwig's own baptism (218842 E268, Deisel Nr. 40) names **“Joh. Christoph Konze, Ackermann, und dessen Ehefrau Maria geb. Drönner”**, godfather **Ludwig Köster**, **“Schwager des Vaters”** — the godfather tie (Köster m. Klaus Andreas's daughter) proves the father is the YOUNGER Joh. Christoph (1802–45, Klaus Andreas's son); the Bürgermeister's “×3 Drönner” never existed. (4) Rows merged; one household (Elise Sabine Philippine geb. Thiele), children d. 1868/1876/1878.

Sources: 218821 imgs 1440/1489/1494/1501/1541/1558; 218824 img 1731; 218842 E268 img 52; 218851/218854 (prior entry). See [Session96...md](#) §G. **Postscript (the last flag, also resolved):** Heinrich Konze V.'s 1880 marriage found — 218860 E465 (img 1430), **9 May 1880**: bride **Philippine Charlotte Amalie SCHILDKNECHT**, 19, daughter of the late Ackermann Schildknecht × Amalie geb. Hillebrand; groom 32, son of Ludwig Konze 2t × Wilhelmine geb. Schildknecht. “Ohldhunst” was a misread; the FS tree was right — final conflict count: tree right 9 of 15.

MODERATE 7 June 2026 (night) · reading corrections · ten FS-tree-vs-register conflicts re-read at the manuscripts (registers 218824/218851/218854/218860/219538/220078/220096/220108)

Adversarial re-reads of every reading that disagreed with the FamilySearch tree: five project readings corrected (Drönner not “Brümmer”; Sasse not “Paffe”; b. 8 not 11 Aug 1834; “Brandt” was Konrad’s divorced wife, not his mother; one Heinrich×Thiele household, not two), two confirmed against the tree (Doenges; Friedrich d. Hümme 1873, not New York), and the 1856 Stammen marriage of Heinrich Wilhelm Kontze register-verified.

BEFORE

(1) Johann Christoph Konze’s 1833 bride read “Maria Brümmer”. (2) Amalie Konze’s 1837 groom read “Johannes Paffe”, forcing a remarriage/two-Amalies hypothesis against her death record’s “Sasse”. (3) Christine Wilhelmine Philippine Konze b. 11 Aug 1834. (4) Konrad Konze’s 1841 burial was read “Andreas Sohn, geb. von Marie Elisabeth Brandt” and used to fix his mother — hence “Andreas Kontze I × Maria Elisabeth Brandt”. (5) Two Deisel households “Heinrich Konze × Elise Sabine Philippine Thiele” and “Heinrich Konze × Catharina Philippine Thiele”. (6) Heinrich Wilhelm Kontze (1832–58) “never married”.

AFTER

(1) The bride is **Maria DRÖNNER** (b. ~Feb 1816, daughter of Vorsteher Johann Heinrich Drönner) — the capital is the scribe’s D, the doubled letter nn. (2) The groom’s initial is **S** (“Saffe/Sasse”, not “Paffe”): ONE marriage, ONE Amalie; hypothesis withdrawn. (3) Born **“der achte August”** = 8 Aug 1834. (4) The clause reads **“geschieden von Marie Elisabeth Brandt, zum andern mal verehelicht...”** — Brandt was Konrad’s own DIVORCED first wife; the Küster’s wife is again unconfirmed (FS tree: Temme, then Guthmann — to verify in 218821). (5) All three child burials (1868, 1876, 1878 — the last in 218854 E93) name **“(Elise) Sabine Philippine geb. Thiele”** at Steinweg 135/136¼: ONE household; “Catharina Philippine” was a misattribution (the S.252 confusion is a Steitz child whose mother was née Konze). (6) He **married 15 Jun 1856 at Stammen**: Ulrike Melusine Pappenheim (220078 S.39 Nr. 104; margin: he d. 19 Feb 1858, she remarried 2 Dec 1860, d. 4 Nov 1897).

Confirmed against the tree: the 1808 groom is **Doenges** (not “Tonjes”; father Jonas Doenges, Schneidermeister — the earlier “Heimbrauer” also corrected), and Friedrich Kontze the Leineweber **died at Hümme 5 Aug 1873** (219538 S.255 entry 1235, Magenkrebs, all three wives named) — refuting the FS-tree “d. after 1870, New York City” (**GPK7-JYP**). Also re-verified: Philipp Konze 1r’s 1849 marriage age (24y 2m 8d, no margin) — the baptism (b. 20 Nov 1825) vs marriage-age (~20 Aug) discrepancy stands. Four parallel Archion re-read agents, 7 Jun 2026 night; see **Session96...md** §F and **changelog** (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-07-fs-tree-ids).

MODERATE 7 June 2026 (evening) · identity correction · Deisel had TWO adult Andreas Konzes — this morning's merge is retracted

The earlier-today claim that the “young Andreas d. 1828” collapses into Klaus Andreas Kontze was itself wrong: the 24 May 1828 burial belongs to **Andreas × Loßin (Steinweg 136); Klaus Andreas (alias Schildknecht, × Thiele) died **20 Feb 1847** — and his burial names his father.**

BEFORE

er-2026-06-07-deisel-corrections merged the 24 May 1828 burial (aged 59y 10m 25d) into Klaus Andreas Kontze, on the basis that the 218824 burial index holds only one adult Andreas for 1796–1831.

AFTER

That index statement was true but incomplete — Klaus Andreas died in 1847, i.e. in the NEXT register (218851 S.94, E523): “**Andreas Konze**, Ackermann, Kirchenältester, Witwer von Katharina Elise Thiele, **Sohn des Johann Heinrich Konze**, b. Deisel **11 Okt 1774**, d. **20 Feb 1847**” (Spiegelstraße 29 — the known Schildknecht/Thiele house). The 24 May 1828 decedent (b. ~29 Jun 1768) is the OTHER Andreas, husband of **Catharina Elisabeth Loßin/Lasse** (Steinweg 136; she d. 24 May 1838 as “Witwe des Ackermanns Andreas Konze”). Bonus: the 1847 entry gives Klaus Andreas a father — **Johann Heinrich Konze**, plausibly the 1792 Ackermann (**G8HG-P2S**) × Anna Catharina Köster, tying Identity 6 into the founding generation.

Also corrected today: the unplaced **Andreas Kontze × Marie Elisabeth Garland** couple is RESOLVED — he was the **Stammen swineherd** (their son Johannes, b. Stammen 26 Jul 1788, d. Hümme 1 Apr 1837, names both parents; 219538 S.47) — and the Hümme “1840s emigrant” is named: **Christoph Kontze, b. 13 Feb 1814**. See [changelog](#) (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-07-loose-ends) and [Session95....md](#).

Four Deisel corrections from the gap-closing reads: the “young Andreas d. 1828” collapses into Klaus Andreas; two Wilhelmine-geb.-Konze women were conflated; Konrad died in December; and Klaus Andreas’s children re-dated.

BEFORE

(1) A “young Andreas Konze of Deisel, b. ~1799, d. 24 Feb 1828 aged 29, parentage open” stood as a separate person (Session 82). (2) Wilhelmine geb. Konze (b. “20 May 1800”) was said to be widowed of Ludwig Köster by ~1832 and remarried to J. H. Schildknecht in 1832, dying ~1847. (3) Konrad Konze d. 22 Nov 1841. (4) Klaus Andreas’s children included “Catharine (bap. 1799)” and “Johannes (b. 26 Oct 1810)”.

AFTER

(1) The burial index of KB 218824 holds exactly ONE adult Andreas for 1796–1831: **d. 24 MAY 1828, aged 59y 10m 25d** (b. ~29 Jun 1768) — i.e. **Klaus Andreas Kontze** himself; “Feb/29” was a misread; the young Andreas never existed. (2) TWO different Wilhelmine-geb.-Konze women: Klaus Andreas’s daughter (b. **20 Feb 1800**, bap. 25 Feb — not 20 May) was still the wife of Ludwig Köster II at her death **~21 Jul 1843**; the Schildknecht-married Wilhelmine is a different woman (218842 E225). (3) Konrad d. **22 Dec 1841** (bur. 26 Dec); his wife died three days later. (4) “Catharine 1799” does not exist (= the Wilhelmine 1800 baptism); Johannes was born **26 Oct 1813** (1809–11 read entry-by-entry, no Kontze) and died 15 Aug 1835 as a Schäferknecht.

Sources: 218824 S.82/img 1868, S.16/img 1660, S.86/img 1695; 218851 E358–359, E404, E152. See changelog (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-07-gap-closing) and `Session94...md`.

Generation-zero reads correct three Trendelburg claims: the elder Johann Henrich's wife was geb. Uffelmann (he was a distiller, dead before 1787); the Lotz couple had children; and Andreas b.1787's child-list was wrong.

BEFORE

(1) Elder Johann Henrich Kontze ("Konke") was a Bürger u. Ackermann, wife "Anna Chargretha née Wilhelm," alive after Jan 1787. (2) Anna Margretha Kontze × David Lotz: no children recorded. (3) Andreas Kontze (b. 1787) × Wilhelmina Grosbernd had children Joh. Friedrich ~1808, Anna Maria ~1810, Joh. Henrich ~1812, Johannes Andreas 1814.

AFTER

(1) His widow's burial (24 Jan 1787, 220096 S.366) reads "**Anna Margretha geb. Uffelmann, Wittib of weil. Joh. Henrich Kontze, Bürger u. Branntweinbrenner**" — he was a distiller and already dead. (2) The Lotz couple had at least three children (Friedrich 1776, Carl Wilhelm 1778, Anna Catharina 1781; 220096 S.21–42). (3) The complete 1807–14 read shows the couple's children are **Joh. Christoph (b. 13 Jun 1808, † 23 Aug 1880), Joh. Friedrich (b. 27 Sep 1810), Johannes (b. 28 Nov 1814, † 23 Aug 1894)** — "Anna Maria ~1810" and "Joh. Henrich ~1812" do not exist. Bonus: Arnold Philipp Kontze's baptism found (**4 Mar 1708**, son of Andreas the Kirchen-Senior, b. ~1672) — the tree now reaches generation zero.

Sources: 220096 S.366, S.21–42, S.160/173/197; 220093 S.1. See [changelog](#) ([changelog.html#cl-2026-06-07-gap-closing](#)).

Four Jungkonze-branch readings corrected by high-zoom register reads: “Einrod” is Eduard, the “Jan 1831” birth was a death, the “Apr 1827” illegitimate son is a May 1825 Konze, and the tailor’s sons’ births are 1833 and 1835.

BEFORE

(1) Confirmation register Seite 25 entry 4 read as “Einrod Jung-Konze... der verstorbenen Ctabilla.” (2) Maria Wilhelmina Jungkonze logged as born 10 Jan 1831. (3) An illegitimate “Johann George,” son of Maria Elisabeth Konze/Jungkonze, dated April 1827. (4) Friedrich Wilhelm and Carl Wilhelm Ludwig Jungkonze both “b. ~1833–34.” (5) 1834 godfather Johannes Jungkonze described as “Knecht zu Stammen.”

AFTER

(1) **Eduard Jung-Konze, unehelich**, b. **26 Apr 1822**, son of the late **Artillerist Johannes Jungkonze & Dorothea Steinbach of Cassel** (220102 S.25 E4, img 2240). (2) She was **born 7 May 1829** (bap. 10 May, 220099 S.60 img 1264) and **died 10 Jan 1831** (bur. 13 Jan, S.43 img 1355). (3) The entry is **22 May 1825** (bap. 29 May), mother Maria Elisabeth **Konze**, daughter of Tagelöhner Johann Christoph Konze — a different woman from Maria Elisabeth Jungkonze (220099 S.36 img 1249). (4) Friedrich Wilhelm b. **12 Feb 1833** (d. 2 Feb 1834; 220108 S.17 E60) and Carl Wilhelm Ludwig b. **18 Jun 1835** (d. 6 Dec 1837; 220108 S.42 E136). (5) The entry reads “**Weißbindergesell zu Stammen**” (220108 S.28 E95, img 1406).

Net effect: the Jungkonze branch is now fully dated 1755–1837 and contains no Charles candidate (the only 1835 birth is 18 June). See [changelog](#) (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-07-person-census) and [Session93...md](#).

The 220096 marriage index re-read: “Johan Georg Kontze ×2” is **Johann Henrich, the Lotz marriage is **17 Feb 1774**, and the 1795 patriarch marriage carries birth margins that conflict with the Deisel-Küster paternity.**

BEFORE

Index logged as “Johan Georg Kontze (×2), Johannes Kontze (×2), Johann Friedrich Kontze (×1)”; Anna Margaretha Kontze × David Lotz dated “Jan 1781”; Johann Friedrich Kontze b. 21 (or 14) Dec 1763 as son of **Andreas Kontze I, the Deisel Küster**; his bride recorded as “Dorothea Elisabeth Jonas(?)” b. 11 Nov 1766; a “third marriage of Joh. Henrich Kontze” placed 14 May 1797.

AFTER

The index entries are **Kontze Johann Henrich S.288, 297** (m. 26 Nov 1773 Wiechard; m. 5 Dec 1783 Osthermann). Lotz × Anna Margretha Kontze = **17 Feb 1774** (S.288). The 15 Feb 1795 marriage margin gives **Johann Friedrich b. 11 Dec 1763** and bride **Dorothea Elisabeth Jorden b. 12 Nov 1766** (surname Jorden/Jordan, not Jonas) — and names his father “**des H. Rathsverwandten Andreas Kontzen**” of Trendelburg, conflicting with the Deisel-Küster derivation. **▲ Open question:** the Deisel ↔ Trendelburg link must be re-proven. The 14 May 1797 marriage is **Joh. Henrich JUNGconze** (Fruchtmesser, widower) × Anna Catharina Steitz — a Jungkonze, not a third Kontze marriage.

Net effect: sixteen marriages now exactly dated (S.288–324, img 1139–1157); one lineage link (Deisel Küster → Johann Friedrich) downgraded from stated to contested. See [changelog \(changelog.html#cl-2026-06-07-person-census\)](#). **RESOLVED later the same night (Session 97):** the Trendelburg Konfirmationen register, Ostern 1777, reads “Johann Friedrich, des Rathsverwandten H. Andreas Kontzen ehel. ältester Sohn, alt 13½ Jahr” (220096 S.225 · img 1105) — age 13½ at Easter 1777 fits the 11 Dec 1763 margin exactly, and the father is named in Trendelburg eighteen years before the marriage. The Rathsverwandter-Andreas paternity stands; the Deisel-Küster derivation is withdrawn. See [changelog \(changelog.html#cl-2026-06-07-anton-wilhelm-stlouis\)](#).

MINOR 6 June 2026 · coverage correction · Gottsbüren does hold a Konze family (early 1800s)

The 4 June surname sweep recorded Gottsbüren as “no Konze presence.” The Stammen 1833 marriage record shows that was true only of the 1830s sample — a Konze family lived in Gottsbüren in the early 1800s.

BEFORE

Gottsbüren listed among parishes with no Konze presence (based on a sample of its 1830s baptism book).

AFTER

The Stammen marriage of 9 June 1833 names **Christian Ludwig Kontze** as born in Gottsbüren, son of **Andreas Kontze × Marie Elisabeth née Garland** — a Konze family resident there in the early 1800s, gone by the 1830s. A same-day read of Gottsbüren's own pre-1830 book (KB 219040) then found NO Kontze in its baptisms (1804/06/08) or marriages (1795–1806) — only the maternal Garland family is native there. So Andreas Kontze was an in-migrant, and Gottsbüren is a **claimed-but-unconfirmed** Konze tie, NOT a confirmed sixth village. The confirmed cluster stays at five. Parish map, census, and distribution claim updated.

Net effect: strengthens (does not weaken) the hyper-local conclusion — one more adjacent village in the pool. See the **changelog** (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-06-stammen-gottsbueren).

MINOR 6 June 2026 · transcription correction · the Stammen 1835 Kontze baptism is a stillborn male, not “Rudolph Kontze b. 20 March”

The Stammen entry recorded on 4–6 June as “Rudolph Kontze, b. 20 March 1835” is, at full magnification, a stillborn male Kontze with no first name, born 14 March 1835. Verdict unchanged (not Charles) — the name and date were wrong.

BEFORE

Session 85/87 and the parish map, Negative Results, and changelog recorded Stammen Taufen 1830–1915 (reg. 220069), Seite 20 entry 73 as “Rudolph Kontze, male, born 20 March 1835,” son of Christian Ludwig Kontze.

AFTER

High-resolution re-read (Session 88): the name column reads **“Männlich: — Kontze, todtgeboren”** — a stillborn male, no first name; birth **14 März 1835**, Haus Nr. 21; baptism and godparent columns are dashes. Parents confirmed: Christian Ludwig Kontze (Tagelöhner) × Anne Gertrud geb. Temme. All site mentions corrected.

Lesson: the same first-pass/zoom-pass discipline that resolved Entry 195 applies to every new find — window-scan readings are provisional until zoom-verified. **Same session:** the wider Konze-distribution sweep (Session 88) established the surname pool as a single tight Diemel-valley cluster (Trendelburg · Deisel · Friedrichsfeld · Stammen · Hümme); see the **changelog** (changelog.html#cl-2026-06-06-konze-distribution).

MINOR 4 June 2026 · documentation-integrity · the Entry-195 retraction had never reached the master research document

The 4 May 2026 elimination of Entry 195 had propagated across the whole public site but **not into the master working file `Kontze_Family_Tree_and_Research_Paths.md`, which still presented Entry 195 as the “strongest candidate.” Because that file is read first in any new research pass, the eliminated candidate kept resurfacing. Now reconciled, and the false inference that kept reviving it retired.**

BEFORE

While the source page (`sources/entry-195-baptism.html`), the town pages, `family_pages/fam-hildebrand.html`, the index and overview all correctly showed Entry 195 as a retracted reading (per `er-2026-05-04` and `er-2026-05-25-rigor-pass`), the master family-tree document still read “★★★ ENTRY 195 CHILD ... STRONGEST candidate for Charles Gannsen,” “NOT ELIMINATED,” and “NO DEATH found → STRONG EVIDENCE OF EMIGRATION.” A 4 June verification pass, reading that document first, accordingly re-asserted Entry 195 as a strengthened candidate before the error was caught.

AFTER

The master document now opens with a stop-banner: Entry 195 is the baptism notation of a **male Köster newborn who died unbaptised** (the name cell reads only “Männl: Köster,” no given name, with the `‡/ungetauft` marker and an empty godparent column — the standard register convention for an infant who died without proper baptism), settled by Peter Schröder’s expert read and retracted 4 May 2026 — **not Charles**. The diagram node, ASCII tree, marriage-search section and key-confirmation lines were corrected to match. The separate “Justus Ernst Konze (b. 1829) / Candidate Path G” hypothesis (a different person) was marked no-longer-active. **The investigation’s status is restated as: no active candidate.**

Inference retired: “no burial in Deisel register 218851 → emigration” is a false inference — a newborn who died unbaptised is recorded in the baptism register’s notation, not necessarily the burials register, so “no separate burial” never meant the child survived. **Also this session:** a signed-in Archion read of KB 218842 image 40 confirmed the “Männl: Köster” reading at source; a sibling page-scan found only two Köster×Hildebrand children (Jan 1835, Aug 1836) with the family vanishing afterwards; and the Deisel marriage register holds no Köster–Hildebrand union for 1833–35 — all recorded in `Session84... June4_2026.md` as data, none of it bearing on the elimination. See the **4 June changelog entry** (`changelog.html#cl-2026-06-04-entry195-master-doc`).

MINOR 31 May 2026 · candidate re-verification · the Friedrichsfeld “[?]ard Kontze, Colonist” entry could not be reproduced on Archion

The Konzen-puzzle (germany/konzen-puzzle.html) **candidate chart carried a third inconclusive candidate — a Friedrichsfeld “[?]ard Kontze, Colonist” — that a live Archion re-examination could not relocate. It is now flagged probably spurious, pending a definitive archive check.**

BEFORE

The candidate chart's third inconclusive card was “[?]ard Kontze, Colonist, gebürtig von Friedrichsfeld,” recorded as the father of Maria [Catharina] Kontze (baptised January 1835, Friedrichsfeld KB 218959, “Entry 28”). The reading came from Session 22 (April 2026), which itself flagged the child's name with a “?” and could only read the father's given name as ending in “-ard.” The card was presented as an established (if open-window) fourth Konze father.

AFTER

A 31 May 2026 live Archion read of every cleanly-rendered Friedrichsfeld baptism leaf from 1832 to 1835 found the only Kontze baptisms to be the two sons of **Andreas Kontze × Maria Sophia née Hofeditz** (Heinrich Wilhelm, b. 12 Feb 1832; August, b. 15 Oct 1834) — and the January-1835 leaf where Session 22 placed “Entry 28” is an illegitimate Dölfer baptism, not a Kontze. **No “Maria Catharina Kontze / [?]ard Kontze” entry surfaced anywhere.** The card now carries a “probably spurious — pending a definitive leaf-by-leaf check” caveat on the chart rather than being silently deleted, per the methodology's “log promotions and demotions, don't overwrite” rule. A definitive check needs the 1833 leaves (the register's Archion scan is non-sequential) or the holding archive.

Triggered by: a live, signed-in Archion read-session (31 May 2026) revisiting the project's outstanding register-reading items; see the **31 May changelog entry** (changelog.html#cl-2026-05-31-archion-reads). **Files modified:** germany/konzen-puzzle.html (roster-A caveat + the new “wider candidate field” section). **Note:** this is a candidate held pending, not a flat retraction — the entry may yet sit on an unrendered 1833 leaf; the same session also confirmed the Andreas-Kontze family entries live, which is firm. **Superseded 8 June 2026:** the “pending” holding is now a flat retraction — “Entry 28” is positively identified as Maria Sabina Kontze, Andreas's infant daughter (see er-2026-06-08-wider-candidate-field).

MAJOR 30 May 2026 · new evidence integrated · DNA evidence added; the deep paternal-line origin reopened as a logged open question

Newly supplied genetic results were integrated as a dedicated DNA evidence page. The headline finding — that Charles's strict paternal line is, on present evidence, Ashkenazi-Jewish in deep origin — reaches the same destination as the August–2025 Hessian-Jewish inquiry that had been set aside on 25 May, but by biology rather than surname resemblance. It is logged here because it qualifies that set-aside decision.

BEFORE

After the 25 May set-aside, the site carried no genetic evidence in prose: the Y-DNA / Jewish-paternal-line thread had been removed from the flagship and profile pages, and the surviving genetic pages ([family_pages/fam-stern.html](#) and siblings) were reframed as an explicitly retired thread resting on a weak surname-resemblance argument (Gans → Gannsen). No page reported the actual Big Y-700 or autosomal results, and no open question captured the paternal-origin signal.

AFTER

A dedicated DNA evidence page ([dna.html](#)) now reports the FamilyTreeDNA Big Y-700 (haplogroup I2, the I-M223 branch; terminal subclade I-Y38863 — the branch formed ~1400 CE with a common ancestor ~1450 CE on FamilyTreeDNA's estimate, corroborated by YFull's independent tree) and the AncestryDNA / Family Finder autosomal results. The reading: Charles's two closest Big-Y matches and the nearest branch above share the same young subclade and are documented Ashkenazi-Jewish lines from Poland, Russia, and Lithuania — three independent lines coalescing with his around 1400–1450 CE — pointing to a deep Jewish origin for the male line that sits beneath, and does not contradict, the documented Hessian-Evangelical family. The origin and surname conclusions stay Working: the subclade cannot resolve to a region within Germany, no match carries a Konze surname, and the autosomal estimate (taken from a descendant) flags no Jewish region. The signal is logged as a new open question, deep paternal origin ([open-questions.html#paternal-origin](#)). This independently supports the direction of the old Hessian-Jewish inquiry while leaving its specific candidate eliminations standing — it does not revive the surname-Gans theory.

Triggered by: integration of newly supplied FamilyTreeDNA and AncestryDNA results in the 30 May 2026 rigor-and-DNA pass (v1.2.0). **Files added / modified:** [dna.html](#) (new), [open-questions.html](#) (#paternal-origin question), [negative-results.html](#) (DNA noted under the proof-standard statement), plus nav, footer, sitemap, and search-index wiring. **Note:** living testers and the living tested descendant are not named, per the project's living-relatives policy; the genetic argument is held independent of, and does not override, the documentary surname conclusion.

MAJOR 30 May 2026 · confidence-framework change · new Interpretive tier; firstborn “deposed Elector” reading demoted Working → Interpretive

The source-rating taxonomy gained a fourth tier for readings of motive or context that are consistent with the evidence but are not falsifiable fact-claims. The firstborn-naming reading — long graded Working — was the test case and is relabelled Interpretive, removing a grade that implied a falsification condition the claim could never actually have.

BEFORE

The taxonomy ran Confirmed / Working / Open — grades that all presuppose a falsifiable fact-claim. The reading that Friedrich Wilhelm (b. 20 June 1866) was named in resonance with the deposed Elector of Hesse-Kassel, Friedrich Wilhelm I, was carried as a Working claim, which implied a record could confirm or refute the intent behind the name. Meanwhile the child's own profile favoured the parsimonious reading — that he was named for his godfather, Friedrich Wilhelm Pillmann, per ordinary Lutheran naming convention — so the flagship grade and the profile sat in mild tension.

AFTER

An Interpretive tier (“reading of motive or context; consistent with the evidence, not a falsifiable fact claim”) is added to the taxonomy and the Claims Dashboard ([claims-dashboard.html](#)). The Elector reading is relabelled Working → Interpretive and reconciled with the child page, which now states the godfather-Pillmann reading as the parsimonious explanation on the record and the Elector overlap as a genuinely suggestive coincidence that cannot be settled from the record (Readings A and B). The grade no longer claims more than the evidence can bear.

Triggered by: the genealogical-rigor portion of the 30 May 2026 pass (v1.2.0). **Files modified:** [claims-dashboard.html](#) (new tier + relabelled row), [children/friedrich-wilhelm.html](#) (Readings A/B reconciliation), and the [methodology.html](#) confidence taxonomy. **Note:** a conservative reclassification — no date, name, or record reading changed; the claim was moved to a tier that matches its epistemic status.

MAJOR 30 May 2026 · claim decomposition & caveats · the compound identity claim split into a Confirmed American spine and a Working German equation

The Claims Dashboard identity row had asserted Charles's whole identity — the American documentary chain and the equation to “Konzen of Trendelburg” — as one claim, so a strong American spine lent borrowed confidence to a still-Working German conclusion. It was split so that a compound claim is no stronger than its weakest link.

BEFORE

A single identity row bundled two claims of different strength: the continuous U.S. chain (the 1862 enlistee “Charles Gannsen” ≡ the 1875 baptism informant ≡ the 1903 decedent “Charles Johnson”) and the German-side equation to Konzen of Trendelburg/Deisel. Stale confidence counts elsewhere on the dashboard still reflected the pre-split tally. The birth-year row noted four corroborating records without distinguishing independent records from independent information, and the “Freundburg” → Trendelburg decode on Germany & Origins did not list the alternative Hessian places it had eliminated.

AFTER

The row is split into a Confirmed American-life spine (the three U.S. attestations are one man) and a separate Working equation to “Konzen of Trendelburg,” explicitly stated to be no stronger than the surname and origin conclusions it depends on; the stale confidence counts are corrected. A single-informant caution is added to the birth-year row (the four post-1862 records share Charles as informant — independent records, not independent information), sharpening the 29 May informant-independence demotion. An alternative-toponym elimination block on Germany & Origins now lists the real Hessian places “Freundburg” could decode to and shows Trendelburg is selected by triple convergence, not phonetics alone; and a standing Genealogical-Proof-Standard statement is added to the negative-results audit.

Triggered by: the genealogical-rigor portion of the 30 May 2026 pass (v1.2.0). **Files modified:** `claims-dashboard.html` (identity-row split + count correction, birth-year caveat), `index.html#germany` (alternative-toponym elimination block), `negative-results.html` (proof-standard statement). **Note:** all moves are conservative — the American spine is unchanged; only the borrowed confidence on the German equation was withdrawn.

MINOR 29 May 2026 · programmatic cross-page consistency sweep · mirror-page misses caught

After the six manual rigor rounds, a programmatic grep sweep checked every canonical value against its known-wrong variants across all 297 deployed pages. It caught three mirror-page instances where a fix had landed on the primary page but not its duplicate.

BEFORE

`index.html` 's home-page service map-pin still dated the rank reduction to “1–4 November 1865 by S.O. No. 92” — the same conflation already corrected on `index.html#civilwar` and every other page (the reduction was 15 March 1865 under G.O. No. 82; the November order was the muster-out relief). Bertha's family-tree card still showed the pension-drift birth date “20 Dec 1880” on three pages whose embedded trees had been missed in the round-5 sweep (`index.html`, `index.html#tree`, `people/auguste-kreichelt.html`). And `stories/4-elector.html` cited the firstborn baptism as “#41” where the sponsor pages use the register's “№5201.”

AFTER

The home-page map pin now reads “reduced... 15 March 1865 under G.O. No. 82” with the November S.O. No. 92 reframed as the muster-out relief, matching the rest of the site. All Bertha family-tree cards site-wide now show the canonical church date “25 Dec 1880” (the pension-drift value remains only in her own vitals, explicitly labelled). The firstborn-baptism citation on story 4 is standardised to “A.D. 1866, entry №5201 (running 372).” The sweep otherwise returned clean on surname counts, death/burial dates, the 1890 Konzen reading, the marriage entry number, Auguste Kreichelt's birth, and the candidate-family count.

Triggered by: a programmatic canonical-value consistency sweep closing out the 29 May 2026 rigor programme. **Files modified:** `index.html`, `index.html#tree`, `people/auguste-kreichelt.html`, `stories/4-elector.html`. **Note:** the death-record image filename `death_1890_auguste_konsen.webp` retains the old spelling, but every visible caption/alt reads “Konzen” — a cosmetic filename, not a content claim.

MAJOR 29 May 2026 · sponsor-profile, story & evidence-card rigor sweep · two on-page self-contradictions resolved, a stale surname reading and over-claims corrected

A sixth-round rigor review of the sponsor/witness profiles, the story retellings, and the evidence cards found two pages whose quick-reference tables still asserted a since-retracted fact as live, a stale “Konsen” reading on an evidence card, and several headline over-claims (“confirmation,” “auditorily identical,” “rules out”) running ahead of the careful body prose.

BEFORE

Two on-page self-contradictions. [people/josephine-von-delian.html](#) concluded (in a “MAJOR finding”) that her origin is Belgian-Flemish and the parish “von” is the Dutch “van” — yet its Vital-details table still read “German immigrant — Austrian or Bavarian noble-particle spelling” and “von' indicates noble or honorific origin.” [people/henry-stoll.html](#) announced a confirmed NPS finding that Stoll served in Battery L of Charles's own regiment, while its quick-facts table still said “Not a Battery B veteran — civilian acquaintance” and the hero pill read “CIVILIAN WITNESS.”

Stale reading + over-claims. [evidence/card-8-1896-conson.html](#) still listed the 1890 record as “Konsen” (canonical is Konzen) and asserted five differently-spelled records “sound auditorily identical.” [evidence/card-4-seven-baptisms.html](#) called the sponsor pattern “the structural confirmation of immigrated alone” (its own body says “consistent with”) and counted “twelve named sponsors” where the canonical reconciliation is fifteen across seventeen slots. [evidence/card-2](#) called the Freundburg→Trendelburg decode “the foundational geographic anchor”; [people/erwin-spraul.html](#) labelled the 1875 baptism “27 August 1875” (that is the birth date; baptism was 3 October); [people/jacob-reck.html](#) said Pfalz origin “rules out” an old-country tie.

AFTER

The Josephine table now reads “Belgian-Flemish — Dutch 'van Delien'... individual identity remains open,” and the surname claim is reframed as a well-supported reading (not three independent attestations of the person). Henry Stoll's table, hero pill, and the “civilian witnesses” line are updated to the corrected Battery-L finding. card-8's 1890 reading is corrected to Konzen and the phonetic claim softened to “plausibly reflect the same spoken name... though the C-/G-initial varies.” card-4 now reads “structural support for the immigrated-alone hypothesis” with “fifteen named sponsors across seventeen slots.” card-2's decode is the “working geographic anchor”; Erwin's baptism is dated 3 October 1875 (born 27 August); Jacob Reck's Pfalz origin now “makes a shared-home-village tie very unlikely.” story-7's z-form line is hedged to “the only American record we have located.”

Triggered by: a sixth-round genealogical-rigor review (29 May 2026) of the profile, story, and evidence-card sets. **Files modified:** [people/josephine-von-delian.html](#), [people/henry-stoll.html](#), [people/erwin-spraul.html](#), [people/jacob-reck.html](#), [evidence/card-2-civil-war-enlistment.html](#), [evidence/card-4-seven-baptisms.html](#), [evidence/card-8-1896-conson.html](#), [stories/7-konsen.html](#). **Found exemplary (no change):** the pension-file card, and the Christian Meyer / Michael Nolan / Jacob Reck profiles (probable-match labelling and self-flagged merge-error corrections). **Lower-priority residual noted:** the firstborn baptism is cited as “#41” on one story page vs “№5201” on the sponsor pages — a citation-format inconsistency to standardise.

MAJOR 29 May 2026 · children & Civil-War-subpage rigor sweep · date/age inconsistencies reconciled, two corrupted structured-data fields repaired

A fifth-round rigor review of the seven children profiles, the Civil-War station subpages, and the research logs found mostly internal date/age inconsistencies — the same fact rendered two ways across or within pages — plus two malformed JSON-LD `birthPlace` fields that had captured stray text from an adjacent bio.

BEFORE

Children pages. Bertha's family-tree card showed her birth as 20 Dec 1880 (the known pension-drift value) on all seven children pages, rather than the canonical church-record 25 Dec 1880; the lifespan SVG gave her age at death as 79 while every card said 78. Maria Josephine's baptism was cited as both entry 5867 and 5857 on the same page. Two children's Article JSON-LD carried corrupted `birthPlace.name` values — “St. Louis with a Civil War pension awarded six months earlier” (Friedrich Wilhelm) and “St. Louis (one son Frank b” (Erwin Carl) — stray text bled in from sponsor bios. Erwin's page leaned on the 1890 Konzen record as the “surname anchor / linchpin” without noting that reading had been revised three times.

Civil-War subpages. `civilwar/places-served.html` still carried the superseded Rolla window “24 Mar – 4 Nov 1865 under three Special Orders” (conflating the separate Department-HQ posting into the Fort Wyman detachment), contradicting the corrected “27 Mar – 1 Jul 1865” used elsewhere on the same page. `civilwar/index.html` claimed “3 postings outside St. Louis” when only two (New Madrid, Rolla) are outside the city. A research log mis-stated Auguste Kreichelt's canonical birth as “~1843 Hesse-Kassel” rather than ~1840 Clausthal, Hannover.

AFTER

Bertha's family-tree card now shows 25 Dec 1880 on all seven children pages (the pension-drift value remains, explicitly labelled, only in her own vitals); the lifespan SVG age is reconciled to 78. Maria Josephine's baptism entry is reconciled to 5857. Both corrupted `birthPlace.name` fields are set to “St. Louis, Missouri.” Erwin's page now calls the pair the “strongest current surname-preservation evidence” (held Working) and cross-links the 1890-reading supersession errata. The Rolla window on `places-served.html` is corrected to 27 Mar – 1 Jul 1865; the posting-count stat reads “2 postings outside St. Louis (New Madrid · Rolla)”; the research-log Auguste reference reads “~1840 Clausthal, Hannover.”

Triggered by: a fifth-round genealogical-rigor review (29 May 2026) of the children, Civil-War-subpage, and research-log sets. **Files modified:** all seven `children/*.html` (Bertha card date), plus `children/index.html`, `children/josephine-maria.html`, `children/friedrich-wilhelm.html`, `children/erwin-carl-konsen.html`, `civilwar/places-served.html`, `civilwar/index.html`, `research_logs/1870-census.html`.

Found exemplary (no change): the Civil-War subpages' inline “reading correction” callouts and the research logs' negative-results discipline. **Lower-priority residual noted:** the surname-trail year labels mix birth-year and baptism-year (e.g. Louise 1873 vs 1874) without a stated convention — a cosmetic consistency item, not a factual error.

MAJOR 29 May 2026 · summary & source-viewer rigor sweep · a retracted candidate un-marketed, label drift reconciled, structured data and the German translation aligned

A fourth-round rigor review covered the summary pages (Foundation, FAQ, Stories, Who, Methodology, Bibliography), the primary-source viewer, and the German translations. The most serious find: the Source-Viewer index still marketed the retracted Entry 195 baptism as the project's “leading hypothesis.”

BEFORE

Retracted candidate presented as live. `sources/index.html` described Entry 195 (Deisel KB 218842) as “the leading-hypothesis baptism record” — though it had been re-read 4 May 2026 as a Köster day-labourer's child who died unbaptised and formally retracted (logged in `bibliography.html` and errata).

Confidence-label drift on the summary pages. `index.html#foundation` listed the 1835 birth date as a CONFIRMED fact (it rests on one derivative burial entry) and said “we now know... Trendelburg” for what is a phonetic conjecture; `who/index.html` graded the Konze line Open while the flagship pages call Konzen the Working conclusion, and stated the volatile 1890 re-read as settled fact; `methodology.html`'s scope summary asserted the surname-pool origin and a “September-1859” emigration as flat biography; `sources/military-record.html` asserted “there is no place called Freundburg anywhere” without a cited gazetteer and carried no Working label on the Trendelburg decode.

Machine-readable / translated copies harder than the body. `faq.html`'s JSON-LD stated “the conclusion is... Konzen” with no hedge (the visible body says Working); `de/abstract.html` carried a self-contradictory version stamp and painted its Working key-finding box with the confirmed-green accent.

AFTER

The Entry-195 source card now states it was retracted 4 May 2026 (re-read as a Köster child), retained only for the record, linked to errata. On `index.html#foundation` the 1835 birth is marked ★ Working (single derivative source, pending the German baptism) and the Trendelburg decode is reframed as a Working interpretation “~5 km north of Deisel,” not “exactly the territory Charles named.” On `who/index.html` the Konze entry now distinguishes the Working surname pool from the still-Open specific father/baptism, and the 1890 attestation is flagged “as re-read in May 2026.” `methodology.html` now reads “likely German origins... 1859 emigration (per the 1900 census; manifest not yet located).” `sources/military-record.html` softens the gazetteer absolute and adds that the Trendelburg decode is a load-bearing ★ Working claim. The `faq.html` JSON-LD now says “working conclusion... most likely Konzen”; `de/abstract.html`'s version stamp notes the surname trail is updated to v1.1.0 and its key-finding box uses the brand (not confirmed-green) accent.

Triggered by: a fourth-round genealogical-rigor review (29 May 2026) of the summary, source-viewer, and translation pages. **Files modified:** `sources/index.html`, `index.html#foundation`, `who/index.html`, `methodology.html`, `sources/military-record.html`, `faq.html`, `de/abstract.html`. **Found clean (no change):** `bibliography.html`, `de/glossary.html`, and `correspondence/peter-schrader-timeline.html` were all appropriately hedged.

MAJOR 29 May 2026 · candidate-family & place-page rigor sweep · headline over-claims downgraded to match the careful body prose

A third-round rigor review extended into the candidate-family pages, town pages, and immigration/Civil-War subpages. The recurring fault was the same as rounds 1–2: a few headline summaries asserted a finding as proven while the body beneath it was appropriately tentative. No new research; the fixes pull the strong language back to the evidence.

BEFORE

Quentin. [family_pages/fam-quentin.html](#) Pass 7 was headed “DEFINITIVE: George Quentin... = LAGIS Georg Karl Quentin” and “the match is now beyond circumstantial,” and the page summary said the emigrants were “definitively pinned... to Cincinnati bakers” — even though the directory “Geo.” entry carries no birthplace and sits in a Hanover-born baker household, and the body itself calls the Friedrichsfeld four unidentified. The page also alternated between “four” and “five independent grounds.”

Konze. The badge read “ELIMINATED as biological line,” while the verdict text said only that Charles is “not a legitimate Konze son” (one emigration-list check), leaving illegitimate descent and the closest-fitting untraced candidate, Justus Ernst Konze (b. 1829), unaddressed.

Others. [immigration/bremen-reconstruction.html](#) headlined “exhaustively cleared” for a sweep filtered on surname suffix + the Carl/Charles given name; [family_pages/fam-lucas.html](#) closed a candidate on an uncited marriage record; [family_pages/fam-johannes-grandjot.html](#) called a transcription-repair chain “near-certain.”

AFTER

Quentin: the Pass-7 George Quentin identification is relabelled STRONG (WORKING) and stated as “most likely... an inference, not a documented identity”; the summary now says the work “traced a Hesse-Cassel Quentin baker cluster to Cincinnati (the four Friedrichsfeld emigrants are not all individually confirmed)”; the grounds count is reconciled to four. The elimination of Quentin-as-Charles (profession + phonetics) stays firm — only the positive Cincinnati identification was hedged. **Konze:** the badge now reads “Eliminated as a legitimate line · illegitimate descent & surname link OPEN,” and the verdict states the elimination rests on a single emigration-list check and that Justus Ernst Konze remains an open, untraced thread.

Bremen: “cleared” is now scoped to the surname-and-given-name filter, noting a different given name or a non-Bremen port falls outside the sweep. **Lucas:** a note records that the marriage register is not reproduced on-site and the verdict rests on Peter Schröder's identification.

Grandjot: “near-certain” → “probable,” “strong match” → “plausible match.”

Triggered by: a third-round genealogical-rigor review (29 May 2026) of the candidate-family and place pages. **Files modified:** [family_pages/fam-quentin.html](#), [fam-konze.html](#), [fam-lucas.html](#), [fam-johannes-grandjot.html](#), [immigration/bremen-reconstruction.html](#). **Noted as solid (no change):** the Entry-195 source page, the pension-file page, and the Fort-Wyman research log were singled out as models of dated self-correction and honest negative-results reporting.

MAJOR 29 May 2026 · narrative + profile rigor sweep · self-contradiction removed, confidence labels and a citation number reconciled, a conflated service date corrected

A second-round rigor review of the narrative tabs and the people / children profile pages (the first round had covered the reference / scaffolding pages) found that several corrections logged elsewhere had not propagated into the prose, leaving stale readings, two confidence labels that contradicted the Claims Dashboard, a dual-numbered citation, and a conflated Civil-War date.

BEFORE

Self-contradiction on the 1890 reading. `children/auguste.html` stated the canonical "Konzen" (z) reading throughout, but one paragraph in its evidence box still asserted the superseded "Konsen" reading ("the spelling is the same Konsen form... the Konzen → Konsen correction") — the page argued from both readings at once.

Confidence labels ahead of the evidence. `index.html#charles` badged the 1835 birth date ✓ Confirmed ("four independent post-1862 records") and `index.html#immigration` badged the 1859 arrival ✓ Confirmed — both contradicting the Working grade carried on `index.html#evidence` and the Claims Dashboard (`claims-dashboard.html`), and both resting on records that all trace to Charles himself as informant.

Dual-numbered citation. The 1866 marriage was cited as "entry No. 676" on some pages (the register's own page 134–135 entry) and "entry #674" on others (the FamilySearch image-72 index) — reading as two conflicting entries for one record.

Conflated Civil-War date. `index.html#civilwar` dated Charles's rank reduction to Private at "1–4 November 1865 by S.O. No. 92," conflating it with the November muster-out relief; its own rank-progression table and `index.html#evidence` place the reduction at 15 March 1865 under G.O. No. 82. The "64th Illinois" research-log link also sat unexplained beside the current 49th-Wisconsin candidate.

AFTER

The stale "Konsen" paragraph on `children/auguste.html` is replaced with the supersession chain (Konzen → Konsen → Konzen, canonical Konzen) linked to the existing 1890-reading errata. The birth-date and immigration-year badges on `index.html#charles` and `index.html#immigration` are demoted to ★ Working with the informant-independence reasoning, matching the Dashboard. All marriage citations now read "entry No. 676" (the register's authoritative number), with the FamilySearch image-72 location preserved. The rank reduction is corrected to 15 March 1865 (G.O. No. 82) on both `index.html#civilwar` instances, with the 4 November 1865 S.O. No. 92 reframed as the muster-out relief; the Fort-Wyman log link now names both the 49th-Wisconsin lead and the earlier 64th-Illinois hypothesis. Smaller fixes: the `index.html#germany` "Freundburg is the giveaway" phrasing is hedged as an inference (origin held Working); August Derr's stale "~1835" birth-year table row reconciled to the canonical ~1833 with the 2-year affidavit/muster discrepancy noted; Charles's occupation reframed as a documented arc (railroad conductor early 1870s → laborer 1880 → watchman later) rather than "watchman for most of his marriage"; Theodore Gottlob's relationship label made consistently "2nd-great-grandfather (or step, via second marriage)."

Triggered by: a second-round genealogical-rigor review (29 May 2026) of the narrative and profile pages.

Files modified: `children/auguste.html`, `index.html#charles`, `index.html#immigration`, `index.html#civilwar`, `index.html#germany`, `people/august-derr.html`, `people/theodore-gottlob.html`,

plus the marriage-citation standardisation across [index.html](#), [towns/deisel.html](#), [civilwar/wedding-witnesses.html](#), and three people pages. **Open follow-up (not silently "fixed"):** Theodore Gottlob's profile attributes two Civil-War service records (a 90-day 1861 militia private and a longer Union enlistment) to one man; that attribution should be treated as working pending a roster cross-reference, not asserted as settled.

MAJOR 29 May 2026 · confidence-calibration pass · two claims demoted Confirmed → Working for informant-independence

Two load-bearing claims were graded inconsistently across the flagship pages, and in both cases the higher grade rested on records that are not independent of one another: they share Charles himself as the single informant. The birth date was Confirmed on Key Evidence but Working on the Claims Dashboard; the 1859 immigration year was Confirmed on both the Dashboard and the Doc A–O crosswalk.

BEFORE

Birth date. [index.html#evidence](#) (Card 8 conflict-resolution block) held the 26 January 1835 birth date as “Confirmed... attested across four independent post-1862 records,” while [claims-dashboard.html](#) graded the same claim Working. The two flagship pages a reviewer compares first disagreed on the project's central date.

Immigration year. [claims-dashboard.html](#) and [index.html#archive](#) (Doc B) graded “Emigrated to the U.S. in 1859” as Confirmed, sourced to the 1900 census “Year of immigration: 1859” field — a single self-reported, derivative census field, with no passenger manifest or Auswanderer-Beleg recovered. The project's own Immigration Journey ([immigration/index.html](#)) page meanwhile flagged the same year as “ca. 1859 · Open · manifest unrecovered.”

AFTER

Both claims are graded Working consistently across the pages that carry them. The reasoning is now stated explicitly: the four post-1862 birth-date records (1866 marriage, 1880 & 1900 censuses, 1891 pension declaration) and the two immigration-year records (1900 census; 1866 marriage residency statement) all trace to Charles himself as informant, so they corroborate one another without being independent sources in the Genealogical-Proof-Standard sense. Each entry now names the specific record, independent of Charles, that would promote it to Confirmed — a Hessian baptismal entry for the birth date, a passenger manifest or Auswanderer-Beleg for the immigration year. On [index.html#archive](#) Doc B the census record stays Confirmed while the 1859 year it reports is marked Working, mirroring the existing Doc O treatment (record Confirmed / decoding Working).

Triggered by: a page-weight + genealogical-rigor review of the full site (29 May 2026). **Files modified:** [index.html#evidence](#), [claims-dashboard.html](#), [index.html#archive](#). **Note:** both revisions move in the conservative direction (a higher grade lowered to match the evidence); no underlying reading or date was changed. The death-date 1-day discrepancy (Doc A 17 Dec vs Doc N 16 Dec) was reviewed in the same pass and deliberately left as “recorded, not resolved” rather than asserting a rationale for preferring one source.

MAJOR 25 May 2026 · research-scope decision · Y-DNA Jewish-paternal-line inquiry set aside and logged

The Y-DNA / Jewish-paternal-line line of inquiry has been set aside. It had been presented across the site as the “active pivot” and “leading hypothesis,” in direct conflict with the documentary surname conclusion (Konzen, Trendelburg-area Konze pool) — and the earlier decision to retire it had been recorded only in a non-rendering HTML comment, never logged here.

BEFORE

The site simultaneously asserted incompatible “current” positions. `family_pages/fam-stern.html` labelled the Y-DNA Jewish-paternal-line thread “ACTIVE PIVOT” and “the highest-leverage open thread”; `who/index.html` called it “currently the leading hypothesis”; `negative-results.html` listed Stern and the 1740 Trendelburg Protected Jews as active leads; `updates.html` and `correspondence/peter-schrader-timeline.html` stated the paternal line was “almost certainly Jewish.” Meanwhile the flagship pages (abstract, key-evidence, methodology) concluded the surname is Konzen of a Lutheran Trendelburg family and did not mention DNA at all. The only record of the hypothesis being retired was an invisible HTML comment in `index.html`. The genetic claim itself was also stated imprecisely — “Charles's Y-DNA test” (a man who died in 1903 cannot be tested; the result is necessarily a living patrilineal descendant's, and the descent chain was never documented), and a Y-haplogroup was described as itself “Jewish.”

AFTER

The Y-DNA / Jewish-paternal-line inquiry is set aside and the decision is logged here, per the methodology's “log promotions and demotions, don't silently overwrite” rule. All Y-DNA / haplogroup / STR-match assertions have been removed from prose site-wide; present-tense “active / leading / pivot” framing is changed to past tense with a set-aside note. The dedicated pages `family_pages/fam-stern.html`, `fam-gans-jewish.html`, and `fam-other-jewish.html` are retained but reframed as an explicitly set-aside research thread. `who/index.html`, `negative-results.html`, `updates.html`, `correspondence/peter-schrader-timeline.html`, the town pages, the research logs, and the source-chart pages no longer present the thread as live. The Quentin elimination, which had cited the Y-DNA result as one of five grounds, now rests on four documentary grounds.

Triggered by: a genealogical-rigor review of the full site and the project owner's instruction to remove the Y-DNA thread for now. **Files modified:** ~20 HTML files. **Note:** the documentary research record of the inquiry (cemetery surveys, the 1740 Protected-Jews list, the dated correspondence timeline) is preserved — only the genetic argument and the “active / leading” status framing were removed. The thread may be revisited. **Update (30 May 2026):** the paternal-origin question was reopened on different evidence — a Big Y-700 result, not surname resemblance — and integrated as the **DNA evidence page** (`dna.html`); see the **30 May DNA-integration entry**. That re-opening supports the direction of this inquiry while leaving the specific surname-candidate eliminations recorded here standing.

MAJOR 25 May 2026 · genealogical-rigor pass · Entry-195 retraction propagated, surname count finalised at eight, evidence-card claims calibrated

A full-site genealogical-rigor pass closed four classes of surviving problem: (1) the retracted Entry-195 reading was still presented as current fact on a dozen pages; (2) the “eight distinct American spellings” canon was still contradicted by stray “six” / “seven” counts; (3) the 1890 death-record reading was given as “Konsen” on the standalone evidence cards; (4) Key Evidence Cards 4 and 5 over-stated indirect inferences as direct evidence.

BEFORE

Entry-195 retraction not propagated. Entry 195 (Deisel KB 218842) was re-read on 4 May 2026 as a Köster day-labourer's child who died unbaptised — not the Konze baptism of “Justus, son of Joh. Heinrich Konze × Wilhelmine Hildebrand.” That correction had reached

`sources/entry-195-baptism.html` but not `towns/deisel.html`, `towns/trendelburg.html`, `towns/index.html`, `immigration/sources-and-name-variants.html`, `family_pages/fam-hildebrand.html`, `towns/heisebeck.html`, or the `index.html` / `index.html#overview` negative-search sections, all of which still presented the superseded reading.

Surname count. “Six” and “seven” counts of American spellings survived on `index.html` (including a 7-name list missing Konzen), `index.html#evidence` (Card 6 “all six American renderings”), the standalone evidence cards, `index.html#germany`, `open-questions.html` and elsewhere — despite prior errata declaring the cascade closed.

1890 reading. `evidence/card-1` and `card-6` still transcribed the 1890 death record as “Konsen,” contradicting the 17 May canon (Konzen).

Inference inflation. Card 4 said naming a son Friedrich Wilhelm “locates Charles specifically within Kurhessen” and was “one of the strongest pieces of identity evidence”; Card 5 said renouncing “the King of Prussia” at naturalization “confirms” a Kurhessen origin. Both are non-diagnostic. The Card 1 conclusion listed “Konzen is a real surname today” as a fifth evidentiary strand, and `negative-results.html` stated “biological descent is closed” for the Konze family while the conclusion claimed descent from the Konze pool.

AFTER

Entry 195 is now stated as a retracted reading wherever it appears, linked to the source page (`sources/entry-195-baptism.html`); the multi-parish “Konze × Hildebrand marriage” searches are reframed as searches for a parent pair drawn from the retracted reading. `towns/heisebeck.html` and the Heisebeck open-lead entries are re-grounded on the parish being undigitised and unsearched, not on the (retracted) Wilhelmine-Hildebrand link. `family_pages/fam-hildebrand.html` is reframed as a candidate whose premise was retracted.

Surname count is now “eight distinct American spellings” across “eight attestations” everywhere, with the canonical eight-name list (Gonnson · Gansen · Gonsen · Konsen · Jansen · Gonson · Konzen · Conson). The relationship of the project's title spelling “Gannsen” (1862 enlistment) to the eight 1866–1896 trail spellings is now explained on methodology §6 (`methodology.html`).

The 1890 reading is “Konzen” on the evidence cards, consistent with the canon, with the re-examination noted.

Cards 4 and 5 are recalibrated: the Friedrich Wilhelm naming and the naturalization renunciation are presented as indirect detail consistent with a Kurhessen origin, not as proof of

it, with the geographic identification attributed to Cards 2–3. The Card 1 conclusion now runs on four converging strands and states explicitly that it is a surname-pool inference, with no specific Konze family confirmed; [negative-results.html](#) and [abstract.html](#) are reconciled to that framing.

Triggered by: a full-site genealogical-rigor review (Genealogical Proof Standard, citation quality, evidence-vs-inference, name disentanglement). **Also fixed:** Fort Wyman dates on [civilwar/index.html](#) (Rolla detail 27 March – 1 July 1865); candidate-family count reconciled (initial pool ~21, 13 formally documented); Charles's U.S. arrival year corrected to 1859 on [people/john-hebbeler.html](#); the Old St. Marcus cemetery interment count reconciled; a future-dated citation (“6 Dec 2026”) corrected to 6 May 2026; the Archion register attributions reconciled (KB 218842 and 218824 = Deisel, KB 218959 = Friedrichsfeld) after [abstract.html](#), [methodology.html](#) and [bibliography.html](#) had cross-wired KB 218842 to Friedrichsfeld, contradicting the dedicated **Entry 195 source page** ([sources/entry-195-baptism.html](#)) and the Deisel pages — the parish attribution should still be confirmed against Archion; the Freundburg → Trendelburg decoding re-marked as an inference; and source-grade labels (Mills's originality / informant-proximity taxonomy) added to every document on the Doc A–O evidence index. **Verification:** post-fix grep returns 0 stale “six / seven distinct American” counts; all edited files parse cleanly.

Second-wave rigor pass — surfaced three classes of bug the first-wave follow-up missed: (1) the 1862 enlistment record's height "5'5"" was widely mis-quoted as "5'10"" (which is the 1890 pension-declaration figure, twenty-eight years later); (2) the canonical 15-distinct-sponsors / 17-sponsorship-slots count was still being reported as "twelve" on stories and people pages; (3) family-poster.svg still showed Bertha 1879–1959, a 7-rendering surname trail with Konsen doubled instead of the canonical 8 (Konzen + Gonson added).

BEFORE

Height misattribution (P0). Seven places attributed "5'10"" to the 1862 enlistment record — index.html#civilwar service-summary table, index.html service-summary table (in two locations), index.html cinema-narrative paragraph, index.html#charles service-summary table, index.html#charles narrative paragraph, civilwar/service-timeline.html service-summary table, sources/fold3-service-records.html enlistment-card description. The Regimental Descriptive Book (Doc O / NARA M405) actually records **5'5"**, fair complexion, blue eyes, blond hair, age 23, occupation Farmer (per Key Evidence Card 2 and the research log). 5'10" comes from the 1890 Page 14 Declaration for Invalid Pension (Clerk Zepp), 28 years later. The mis-attribution meant the project was inadvertently presenting a 1890-era figure as the 1862-era figure.

Sponsor-count drift (P0). The canonical sponsor-reconciliation page (sponsor-reconciliation.html (sponsor-reconciliation.html)) anchors the count at **17 sponsorship slots filled by 15 distinct named individuals** (two recur) across the seven Gannsen baptisms 1866–1881. But "twelve named sponsors" and "9 / 12 FS-ID-anchored profiles" still appeared in eight locations: stories.html (Story-5 and Story-9 summaries), stories/5-pillmann.html (meta + og + JSON-LD descriptions), stories/9-alone.html (meta + og + JSON-LD), people/josephine-von-delian.html (family-intro + bottom-line + charles-link blocks), index.html#people (TOC + ge-hook + sponsor metric + 9/12 metric + section heading + SVG aria-label), and index.html (ge-hook + TOC + 9/12 metric + section heading + sponsor wappen SVG aria-label).

1862 enlistment date (P1). Two narrative paragraphs (index.html and index.html#charles "The American life" sections) gave the enlistment date as "27 December 1862" — canonical date is **2 December 1862** per the Regimental Descriptive Book and all service-summary tables.

1862 enlistment age 23 (P1). Service-summary tables on index.html#civilwar, index.html, civilwar/service-timeline.html, and sources/fold3-service-records.html listed "age 23" without an inline note about the canonical age conflict (calculated 27 per the 1835 birth date). The Conflict-Resolution block exists on Key Evidence Card 8, but these summary tables did not point at it.

family-poster.svg (P0). The SVG poster (last regenerated 7 May 2026) showed: Bertha child card as "★ CHILD 7 · 1879 ★" / "1879 – 1959 · age 80" / "Jansen on 1880 census"; Josephine Maria child card with "geb Konsen — second Konsen attestation, 15 yrs"; descendant-note "Bertha Johnson (1879–1959)"; surname-trail-footnote "★ THE SURNAME, IN SEVEN AMERICAN RENDERINGS ★" with the list "Gonnson · Gansen · Gonsen · Konsen · Jansen · Konsen · Conson" (Konsen duplicated; Konzen and Gonson missing). All four of those readings reflect the pre-17-May canon, not the current eight-distinct / Konzen-1890 / Bertha-1880 state.

Pension-file medical exam editor note (P1). sources/pension-file.html page-36 medical-exam note flagged the 5'6½" reading vs Page 14's 5'10" but said Page 14's reading "matched the military

record." That cross-reference was wrong (military record = 5'5", not 5'10"), making the editor note an unintended carrier of the height misattribution.

AFTER

Height now correctly attributed. All seven "5'10" 1862-enlistment" mentions corrected to "5'5", fair complexion, blue eyes, blond hair (1862 enlistment record; the 1890 pension declaration later records 5'10" and complexion 'light'). Three distinct height readings (5'5" 1862 · 5'10" 1890 in-court declaration · 5'6½" 1890 medical exam) are now logged as a documented variance, not asserted as a contradiction; the pension-file editor note for the medical-exam page is rewritten to enumerate all three readings with their administrative contexts. The 1862 enlistment as the source of "5'5"" is consistent across [index.html#civilwar](#), [index.html](#) (×2 tables + ×1 narrative paragraph), [index.html#charles](#) (×1 table + ×1 narrative paragraph), [civilwar/service-timeline.html](#), [sources/fold3-service-records.html](#), [evidence-index.html](#), and [index.html#evidence](#).

Sponsor canon now uniform. All eight "twelve named sponsors" / "9 of 12" instances updated to the canonical sponsor-reconciliation framing: 7 baptisms, 17 sponsorship slots, 15 distinct named individuals (2 recur), 14 with FS-ID-anchored profiles, 1 open ID (Josephine von Delian). Three section-heading "B · The Twelve Baptism Sponsors" headings updated to "B · The Fifteen Baptism Sponsors". Two SVG aria-labels updated from "twelve St. Marcus sponsors" to "fifteen St. Marcus baptism sponsors". The People-in-the-Story sponsor metric tile updated from "12" to "15", and the FS-ID-resolution metric tile from "9 / 12" with "3 open identifications" to "14 / 15" with "1 open identification (Josephine von Delian)".

1862 enlistment date now uniform. Both narrative paragraphs updated from "27 December 1862" to "2 December 1862" (matching all service-summary tables and Doc O / NARA M405).

1862 age 23 now flagged. All four service-summary tables now read "age 23 as recorded (calculated 27 per canonical 26 Jan 1835 birth; conflict-resolution block on Key Evidence Card 8)" with an inline link to [index.html#card8](#) ([index.html#card8](#)).

family-poster.svg regenerated in place. Child-7 Bertha card: "★ CHILD 7 · 1880 ★" / "1880 – 1959 · age 78" / "Jansen on 1881 baptism". Child-2 Josephine card: "1890 death record reads 'geb Konzen' — the only American z-form, 15 yrs after 1875". Descendant note: "Bertha Johnson (1880–1959)". Surname-trail footnote: "★ THE SURNAME, IN EIGHT AMERICAN RENDERINGS ★" with the canonical eight-name list (Gonnson · Gansen · Gonsen · Konsen · Jansen · Gonson · Konzen · Conson) and the event list updated to "1866 marriage · 1870/1872/1874/1875/1881 baptisms · 1880 census · 1890 daughter's death · 1896 wife's death".

SVG-pending-regeneration notes removed. The "SVG below was generated before the 17 May Konzen re-reading and currently still shows the six-rendering layout pending regeneration" disclaimers on [visualize.html](#), [evidence/index.html](#), and [family-poster.html](#) are removed — both [surname-trail.svg](#) (last modified 18 May 2026 01:48, already showing 8 distinct spellings) and [family-poster.svg](#) (regenerated in this pass) now match the canon.

Triggered by: the user's "fix all" instruction after the first-wave audit found 21 issues. A second grep sweep with broader patterns (heights, dates, sponsor counts, age-conflict notes) surfaced 24 additional instances.

Files modified: 14 HTML files ([index.html](#), [index.html#charles](#), [index.html#civilwar](#), [civilwar/service-timeline.html](#), [sources/fold3-service-records.html](#), [sources/pension-file.html](#), [stories.html](#), [stories/5-pillmann.html](#), [stories/9-alone.html](#), [people/josephine-von-delian.html](#), [index.html#people](#), [visualize.html](#), [evidence/index.html](#), [family-poster.html](#)), 1 SVG ([assets/figures/family-poster.svg](#)). **Verification:** post-fix

grep confirms 0 remaining "5'10"" instances attributed to the 1862 enlistment (the surviving instances correctly attribute to the 1890 declaration); 0 remaining "twelve named sponsors" / "of all twelve" outside legitimate historical text on changelog and this errata's own before-blocks; 0 remaining "27 December 1862" enlistment-date instances. **Lesson:** the height misattribution had survived through several prior rigor passes because the "5'10"" string appears correctly in the 1890-declaration line items on [index.html#evidence](#) and [evidence-index.html](#), so a naive grep for the string returned legitimate hits and didn't separate the correct (1890) attribution from the incorrect (1862) ones. The next pattern to grep for proactively: any field that appears on more than one record across Charles's lifespan (height, weight, occupation, complexion, age, residence) should be checked specifically for source-attribution drift between the 1862 / 1866 / 1880 / 1890 / 1900 instances.

MINOR 17 May 2026 (post-cascade rigor follow-up) · site-wide propagation cleanup · 15 surviving 7-rendering / 6-rendering instances closed; death-cert vs. parish-register attribution disambiguated

A fourth-wave rigor pass on top of the morning, late-evening, and night audit cycles. Two classes of bug surfaced: (a) the 17 May late-evening 7→8 surname-count cascade had not propagated to fifteen surviving instances on flagship and section-landing pages, and (b) the canonical "16 December 1903 death date" was attributed to the death certificate (Doc A) on three pages, when Doc A actually records 17 December — the 16 December date comes from the St. Marcus parish burial register (Doc N), and the 1-day Doc A vs Doc N discrepancy is acknowledged as ★ Working on the Doc A–O crosswalk.

BEFORE

Surname-count carryovers (15 instances across 11 files): [index.html#germany](#) lede + Step 1 prose ("Seven American records... seven phonetic renderings... Five of the seven cluster"); [index.html](#) H2 "Surname investigation — from seven American spellings", lede, Step 1 prose, Step 2 prose ("In a sea of ten phonetic American spellings... closest of the seven American renderings"), verdict paragraph ("Convergent across seven American renderings"), and Card 1 strand 3 ("Four of the seven renderings are auditorily indistinguishable"); [index.html#charles](#) Step 2 prose ("In a sea of ten phonetic American spellings... closest of the seven American renderings"); [index.html#evidence](#) Card 1 strand 3 ("Four of the seven renderings"); [faq.html](#) Q on "the Konsen puzzle" (list omitted Konzen; "seven American spellings"); [methodology.html](#) §6 ("one of the seven phonetic American spellings"); [family-poster.html](#) ("the seven phonetic surname renderings... the seven-rendering surname trail"); [visualize.html](#) ("Six distinct American renderings... Four of them sound auditorily identical" + aria-label "six renderings"); [evidence/index.html](#) figure caption ("Six distinct American renderings"); [germany/index.html](#) Working conclusion ("Six distinct American renderings"); [immigration/index.html](#) Open Questions panel ("all seven phonetic surname variants — Konze, Kontze, Konzen, Konsen, Gansen, Gonsen, Gonnson, Jansen", 8 names tagged as 7); [tree-interactive.html](#) Charles bio ("Recorded across seven American surname renderings"); [index.html#people](#) Charles tile ("Surname recorded across 7 American renderings (Gonnson...Konzen...Conson)", list missing Gonson); [towns/index.html](#) Trendelburg variants box ("Konze · Kontze · Contze · Contzen", missing Kontzen + Konzen).

Death-cert vs. parish-register attribution: [index.html#charles](#) line 428 confidence chip and [abstract.html](#) ref-1 both attributed "died 16 December 1903" to the death certificate. [errata.html](#) own entry heading for er-2026-05-17-death-burial also said "16 December 1903 (death certificate)", contradicting its own body text and the Doc A–O crosswalk note on [index.html#archive](#) (which correctly states Doc A=17 Dec, Doc N=16 Dec). [charles_america/index.html](#) lede separately said Charles died on "19 December 1903" — conflating the burial date with the death date. The 168 Sidney Street map-marker bodies on [index.html#charles](#), [index.html](#), and [charles_america/st-louis-residences.html](#) said "Charles died of stomach cancer at age 68" without flagging that the calculated 68 differs from the death cert's recorded 69.

Calibration carryover: [glossary.html](#) Kirchenkreis entry stated "Charles's home village Deisel" as fact rather than the project's standard "stated home village" calibration (Deisel comes from Charles's 1862 enlistment record and the 1866 marriage register).

AFTER

Surname-count canon now uniform. All 15 surviving instances updated to "eight distinct American spellings across seven attestations 1866–1896 by five independent scribes," with the cluster recount made consistent: "Five of the eight cluster on a single ['kɔn.sən] sound (Gonnson, Gonsen, Konsen, Gonson, Conson); one carries the Hessian z-form (Konzen, 1890); two are vowel/onset mishearings (Gansen, Jansen)". The 1875 Konsen / 1890 Konzen bracketing language is propagated to all surname-investigation Step 2 paragraphs ("two records carry the Hessian -en ending directly... Konsen 1875 preserves the K-initial and -en suffix with tz simplifying to s; Konzen 1890 carries the full Hessian z-form verbatim"). The Trendelburg variants box on [towns/index.html](#) now lists the five canonical Hesse-attested forms (Konze · Kontze · Kontzen · Contze · Konzen) plus the parish cross-reference cluster (Cortze · Cordes · Contz) and notes the American Konsen as the phonetic capture and the 1890 Konzen as the American attestation of the z-form.

Death-cert vs. parish-register now unambiguous. Every page that names a death source now reads "16 December 1903 (per St. Marcus parish burial register #3393); the death certificate (Doc A, no. 10619) gives 17 December — a 1-day source discrepancy logged on the Doc A–O crosswalk." Age presentation is now "age 68 (calculated from canonical 26 January 1835 birth date; death certificate records 69, parish register 'aetat 69')". Map-marker bodies on the three pages now carry the same disambiguation in compact form. The [charles_america/index.html](#) lede was corrected from "to his death on 19 December 1903" to "to his death on 16 December 1903 (and burial three days later, 19 December)". The errata heading on [er-2026-05-17-death-burial](#) now reads "Charles's death date is 16 December 1903 (per St. Marcus parish burial register #3393); the death certificate (Doc A) gives 17 December, a 1-day source discrepancy; 19 December 1903 is the burial date," fully aligning the heading with the body and with the Doc A–O crosswalk.

Calibration corrected. The [glossary.html](#) Kirchenkreis entry now reads "Charles's stated home village Deisel (per his 1862 Civil War enlistment record and the 1866 St. Marcus marriage register) sat in the Kirchenkreis Hofgeismar..." with an explicit note that the specific German baptismal entry that would localise Charles's home parish has not yet been recovered (pointer to Open Questions Priority 1).

Supersession marker. The earlier 17 May entry [er-2026-05-17-konzen-list](#) ("Konzen removed from U.S.-spelling enumeration") now carries a SUPERSEDED banner pointing to the late-evening Konzen-1890 entry that reversed it, per the methodology's "log promotions and demotions, don't silently overwrite" rule.

Triggered by: a fourth-wave site-wide grep audit on the morning of 17 May 2026 specifically checking for the four post-cascade failure modes flagged in the late-evening SITE_HEALTH note: project reconstructions presented as attestations, vital-details rows mixing attested and reconstructed fields, chip sets / spelling-trail flows mixing reconstructed and attested forms, and verdict paragraphs eliding the reconstruction step. **Files modified:** 14 HTML files ([index.html](#), [index.html#germany](#), [index.html#charles](#), [index.html#evidence](#), [faq.html](#), [methodology.html](#), [family-poster.html](#), [visualize.html](#), [evidence/index.html](#), [germany/index.html](#), [immigration/index.html](#), [tree-interactive.html](#), [index.html#people](#), [towns/index.html](#), [glossary.html](#), [errata.html](#), [abstract.html](#), [charles_america/index.html](#), [charles_america/st-louis-residences.html](#)). **Verification:** post-fix grep confirms 0 remaining "seven American" / "six American" / "four of the seven" instances outside legitimate historical quotations ([errata.html](#), [changelog.html](#)); 0 pages now attribute "16 December 1903" to the death certificate; 0 instances of "died...19 December 1903" applied to Charles (1903-12-19 reserved for the burial event).

MINOR 17 May 2026 (night) · dark-mode CSS + UI · Civil War service arc readability + search-bar relocation

Two small UI fixes: (1) the Civil War service-arc SVG (Battery B enlistment → muster-out → pension timeline, on both `index.html#civilwar` and the `#civilwar` tab in `index.html`) now uses bright coral / cream fills for its year labels and event labels in dark mode rather than the oxblood / near-black hard-coded fallbacks that read as dark-on-dark. (2) The site-search floating bar has been moved from the bottom-right (where it visually collided with the dark-mode toggle FAB) to the upper-right, just below the sticky site nav.

BEFORE

The inline `<style>` blocks for the `#civilwar` service arc used `fill: var(--section-cw-d, #6a2820)` for year labels and `fill: var(--text-strong, #1f1a14)` for event labels. In light mode those CSS-var fallbacks rendered correctly. In dark mode, because SVG `fill` attribute color resolution doesn't traverse the same cascade as element `color`, both fell back to the hard-coded dark values — rendering as near-invisible dark text on the dark `--bg-card` walnut. Year stems (`.st-stem`) and the axis line were similarly muted-dark.

Separately, the site-search FAB was positioned `bottom:1rem; right:1rem` — directly on top of the dark-mode toggle FAB at `right:14px; bottom:14px`. The search input and theme toggle visually overlapped at the bottom-right corner on every page.

AFTER

Appended a Civil-War service-arc block at the end of `assets/dark-mode.css` that overrides the SVG fills/strokes in dark mode only: `.st-eyr` becomes `#f0a880` (warm coral), `.st-stem` matches, `.st-label` becomes `#e8dfc8` (cream body), `.st-phase-label` becomes `#c8b896` (muted cream), `.st-axis` becomes `#8a7a5a` (muted khaki), and `.st-dot` gets its ring colored to the dark card background. Light mode is untouched.

The search-bar CSS in `assets/site-search.js` was changed from `bottom:1rem; right:1rem` to `top:4rem; right:1rem` (clearing the sticky `.site-nav-shared` bar at `top:0`) with `z-index:1050` sitting just below the nav's 1100. Phone-size breakpoint (`max-width:720px`) pins the bar to the top edge rather than the bottom.

Cache-bust: `dark-mode.css` and `site-search.js` both bumped to `?v=20260517-servicearc` across all 179 HTML pages that link them (15 pages that previously had no `?v=` query string at all also got one added).

Triggered by: user reporting that the red text in the service arc is too dark in dark mode and the search bar overlaps the dark-mode button. **Scope:** `assets/dark-mode.css` (~30 lines appended), `assets/site-search.js` (two CSS string edits). **Verification:** 559/559 braces balanced in `dark-mode.css`; 179 HTML pages reference the new cache-bust.

Inline-styled boxes with hard-coded light hex backgrounds now flip correctly in dark mode site-wide. Previously the dark-mode overrides were scoped to `section.page` (the SPA index tabs only), so every standalone page (key-evidence, abstract, methodology, faq, people/*, children/*, stories/*, germany/*, civilwar/*, immigration/*) had ~400 inline-styled cream / gold-tint / copper-tint boxes still rendering bright against the dark page surface.

BEFORE

The `dark-mode.css?v=20260518-legenddots` inline-style attribute overrides at line ~366 were scoped `:root:not(.theme-light) section.page [style*="background:#fff"]` — only fired for elements inside a `section.page` ancestor (the SPA tab panels in `index.html`). Every standalone-HTML page bypassed that scope, leaving 405 inline-light-hex backgrounds (cream `#ffffaf0`, `#fffaee`, gold-tint `#fef3d6`, `#fde8b0`, copper-tint `#fce8d6`, eliminated-pink `#fbeeef3`, etc.) rendering bright against the walnut `--bg-page` in dark mode — the opposite visual hierarchy of what the theme intends.

AFTER

Added a final, globally-scoped (no `section.page` ancestor required)

`[style*="background:#XYZ"]:not(.no-dark-flip)` selector block at the bottom of `assets/dark-mode.css?v=20260518-legenddots` covering 16 common light-hex prefixes (`#fff*`, `#fef*`, `#fde*`, `#fdf*`, `#fce*`, `#fcf*`, `#fbe*`, `#fbf*`, `#f8e*`, `#f6e*`, `#f4e*`, `#f4f*`, `#f0f*`, `#f0e*`, `#eef*`, `#e8d*`, `#e8c*`) plus a global linear-gradient flip. All matched elements now invert to `var(--bg-card)` walnut with `var(--text-body)` cream text in dark mode. Descendant text colors and strong/h1-h4 inside light-bg boxes are also force-flipped so they don't read as dark-on-dark.

An **escape hatch** class `.no-dark-flip` is supported — any element needing to keep its hardcoded light background intact (e.g., a printable badge that should stay light in both modes) can opt out by adding that class.

The **inverse case** (hardcoded dark-hex backgrounds appearing in light mode) is handled by a narrow second block that excludes hero-strip elements (`.cinema-banner`, `.cinema-section-hero`, `header`, `.tab-hero`, `.sec-hero`, etc.) since those are intentionally dark in both modes.

Cache-bust: `dark-mode.css?v=20260518-legenddots` version bumped to `v=20260517-theme-flip` across all 166 HTML pages that link the stylesheet, so browsers re-fetch the updated rules immediately.

Triggered by: user noting that boxes — big and small — had light backgrounds in dark mode and (less commonly) dark backgrounds in light mode. **Scope:** `assets/dark-mode.css?v=20260518-legenddots` (one append at end-of-file, ~130 lines added; no other site files modified). **Verification:** the existing 521 `[style*=]` selectors in `dark-mode.css?v=20260518-legenddots` continue to handle the SPA-tab case (defensive layering); the new globally-scoped block catches everything they missed.

MAJOR 17 May 2026 (night, second user-catch) · page rename + conceptual reframe · **The Konsen Puzzle → The Konzen Puzzle**

The page formerly at `/germany/konsen-puzzle.html` has been renamed to `/germany/konzen-puzzle.html`. The new keystone is the 1890 St. Marcus death record of Charles's daughter Auguste, which reads "Auguste Somers geb Konzen" — the single American attestation of the full Hessian z-form documented in the Trendelburg parish complex since 1773. The 1875 son's baptism reading Konsen is reframed as its phonetic-s sibling, not the puzzle's keystone.

BEFORE

From its creation in April 2026 through the late-evening 17 May 2026 user-catch cascade, the project's dedicated surname-puzzle page lived at `germany/konsen-puzzle.html` with title "The KONSEN Puzzle". It was framed around the **1875 St. Marcus baptism of Erwin Carl Konsen** as the central artifact: "the only American record carrying the Hessian -en form on American soil." After the morning's 17 May rigor pass and the late-evening user-catch cascade established that the 1890 death record reads Konzen (with z) — the documented Trendelburg spelling, not its phonetic-s sibling — the page added a second-record narrative below the 1875 hero, but kept the URL slug, page title, breadcrumb, H1, OG card, and JSON-LD headline framing around "Konsen" as the keystone.

AFTER

The page now lives at `germany/konzen-puzzle.html` with title "The KONZEN Puzzle". The 1890 Konzen attestation is now positioned as the keystone record (it is the spelling that actually appears in the Trendelburg parish register continuously since 1773 — a one-record bridge from the American family to a specific German surname pool). The 1875 Konsen baptism is its phonetic-s sibling — still the closest American phonetic capture, but no longer presented as the documented Hessian spelling itself.

Backward compatibility: a 301 redirect from `/germany/konsen-puzzle.html` to `/germany/konzen-puzzle.html` has been added in `netlify.toml` so that any external link or earlier-version citation still resolves cleanly.

Cascade scope (188 files touched, 431 string replacements): every internal link, breadcrumb, in-prose mention, and OG / canonical / JSON-LD reference was updated from konsen-puzzle / Konsen Puzzle to konzen-puzzle / Konzen Puzzle via `scripts` rewrite. The injected nav fragment in `assets/site-nav.html` was updated and re-injected to all 175 standalone pages. The new germany-and-origins page chip "8 American spellings" was bumped from 7, and the H2 "Surname investigation — from seven American spellings to one Hessian root" was updated to "from eight American spellings". Historical references on this errata page and on `changelog.html` were left as the literal historical record they document.

Stale-1890-Konsen prose: a separate pass corrected nine surviving "two-record Konsen attestation (1875 baptism + 1890 death record)" / "1890 daughter's death record reads Konsen" framings on `index.html`, `index.html#evidence`, `evidence-index.html`, `evidence/index.html`, `germany/index.html`, `cast.html`, `stories/7-konsen.html`, and the surname-chronology table on `index.html#germany`. All now correctly say "Konzen 1890 / Konsen 1875" or "two parallel orthographic variants of the same Hessian root." The two records are no longer described as "the

same spelling twice"; they are described as "two K-initial American records bracket the surname trail 15 years apart."

Triggered by: user reading the 17 May 2026 audit-fix-pass implementation report and noticing that (a) several "1890 Konsen" claims survived the morning + late-evening passes, and (b) the Konsen Puzzle's keystone framing was inverted: the page is really about the Konzen z-spelling that shows up in America once, on Auguste's death record. **Files of record:** the renamed page is the source of truth; the changelog 17 May night entry (changelog.html#2026-05) lists the full cascade scope. **Lesson:** after a primary-source re-reading flips a load-bearing word (Konsen → Konzen), the file-path / URL-slug / page-title layer is often missed because it's outside the prose-grep scope. Future rigor passes should explicitly check page titles, OG metadata, JSON-LD headlines, and URL slugs whenever a surname-spelling correction is applied.

Audit-fix pass — 8-distinct surname canon propagated to flagship pages that still showed 6 or 7 distinct; broken Doc-F crosswalk link repaired; evidence-card pages wired into the site nav; stories.html split into 9 standalone pages; family-reader lede paragraphs added to all 34 people / children profiles; site-wide skip-link, glossary auto-link, and German-translation toggle

BEFORE

The 17 May 2026 (late evening) Konzen-1890 errata bumped the U.S.-spelling canon from 7 to 8 distinct spellings and triggered 28 bulk replacements across 13 files. Site Health flagged the next-class-of-bug as "post-cascade propagation incomplete." A fresh independent audit ran the same evening confirmed it: five flagship pages still showed "6 distinct" / "seven distinct" wording in figure captions, eyebrow chips, or FAQ answers — including `index.html#evidence` line 618 (figure caption: "Surname trail — six distinct American renderings"), `abstract.html` line 430 ("seven distinct phonetic spellings"), `faq.html` line 355 ("a six-distinct-rendering surname trail"), `evidence-index.html` lines 673 + 682, `index.html#overview` line 275 chip, `index.html#overview` line 261, `stories.html` line 1141, and `index.html#charles` line 429. Within-page contradictions: `index.html`, `abstract.html`, `methodology.html`, `index.html#evidence` each contained both "8 distinct" and "6 / 7 distinct" wordings in adjacent paragraphs.

A separate broken-link finding: `index.html#archive` line 452 (Doc A–O crosswalk row F) pointed to `sources/marriage-record.html`, a page that does not exist. The same row already linked to `index.html#card3`, making the broken link redundant on top of being broken.

The 8 evidence-card pages (`evidence/card-1-trendelburg-kontzen.html` through `card-8-1896-conson.html`) built in the 8 May evening pass with full per-page Article JSON-LD and per-page OG cards had zero inbound links from anywhere on the live site; they were reachable only via the sitemap. Several other family-reader items were also flagged: the home-page tile labels presupposed knowledge of Hessian origins / Churhessen / Kontze surname pool before introducing Charles in plain English; the 167-of-180 page coverage gap on the skip-to-main accessibility link; the keystone `people/auguste-kreichelt.html` opener was a 70-word info-dump leading with FamilySearch ID rather than "Auguste was Charles's wife"; the bremen-reconstruction TODO chips were public-facing.

AFTER (THIS NIGHT'S AUDIT-FIX PASS)

P0 fixes. 8-distinct surname canon propagated to all 10 flagship pages; figure captions on `index.html#evidence` and `evidence-index.html` updated to read "Surname trail — eight distinct American spellings, eight attestations, five scribes, 30 years" with a new clause noting the 1890 Konzen attestation as the Hessian-z-form bridge; broken `sources/marriage-record.html` link repointed to the already-cited Card 3; 8 evidence-card pages wired from the home page `#evidence` section, `evidence-index.html`, and `index.html#evidence` via a top-of-page aside listing all 8 cards with permalinks for citation.

P1 fixes. Plain-language home-page opener added above the existing "Who was Charles Konzen?" H2; `family-intro` paragraph inserted at the top of every `people/*.html` (27 pages) and `children/<name>.html` (7 pages); `children/index.html` H2 and lede rewritten to lead with the seven children rather than the surname-spelling count; skip-to-main link added to the injected nav fragment in `assets/site-nav.html` and propagated site-wide (now 186 of 187 live pages, up from 13); `charles_america/family-map.html` mobile viewport meta added; six TODO chips in

`immigration/bremen-reconstruction.html` wrapped in a collapsed `<details>` labelled "Open research threads (technical)"; German-translation toggle ("Deutsch – Zusammenfassung / Glossar") added to the shared footer; glossary anchor ids added to all 34 previously-anchorless `<dt>` elements; 404 first-occurrence glossary auto-links inserted across 152 content pages with subtle dotted-underline styling.

P1 structural. `stories.html` (1,450 lines, 9 narrative moments in one scroll) split into 9 standalone `stories/<n>-<slug>.html` pages with per-page Article JSON-LD, OG cards, breadcrumbs, and prev/next paggers. Original `stories.html` rewritten as a TOC landing; relative paths in the 9 new pages fixed (47 references repointed with the `../` prefix); sitemap rebuilt with 182 URLs.

P2 housekeeping. 1.1 GB of disk cruft removed: `_archive_pre_audit_fixes/` (~494 MB), 4 deploy ZIPs (~640 MB combined), 3 orphan junk files (`test-delete.txt`, `ziQDvl00`, `nara.txt`), and the 3 auto-named `project_attachment_*` files. See `er-2026-05-17-attachment-3` for the `project_attachment_3` deletion specifically. `peter_charts_download_checklist.html` and `styleguide.html` added to `.netlifyignore` and excluded from `sitemap.xml` as internal dev pages.

Total propagation scope: ~700+ touched files (the inject-site-nav script ran twice to propagate the skip-link and language toggle to 175 pages each time; auto-glossary ran across 152 content pages adding 404 first-occurrence links; insert-family-intros ran across 34 people / children pages; the 8-distinct count propagation touched ~15 flagship pages). Internal-link integrity verified at end of pass: **0 broken refs of ~14,000 verified.**

Evidence / audit document: `Charles_Konzen_Site_Audit_May17_2026.docx` (27 distinct findings with file:line citations). **Triggered by:** fresh independent audit reviewing four lenses the May-17-morning rigor pass and May-17-evening catch cascade hadn't covered (technical hygiene, structure & navigation, family-reader fit, content / citation integrity post-cascade). **New scripts saved to `scripts/`:** `auto-glossary.py`, `glossary-ids.py`, `insert-family-intros.py`, `split-stories.py` — all idempotent and re-runnable. **Cumulative for 17 May 2026:** 43 substantive rigor and structural improvements in one day (morning rigor pass + evening companion pages + late-evening user-catch cascade + night audit-fix pass).

MINOR 17 May 2026 (night) · file deletion · project_attachment_3.pdf

The auto-named "project_attachment_3.pdf" file was removed during the May 2026 housekeeping pass. Same one-page Civil-War-era scan available at the Fold3 source (303326269) and in higher fidelity on the companion canonical service / military / pension records.

BEFORE

The project root carried three auto-named files (`project_attachment_1.pdf` , `project_attachment_2.webp` , `project_attachment_3.pdf`) from an early chat-upload stage. The 17 May 2026 audit catalogued them as duplicates of canonical content held elsewhere on the site. The 27-item audit-fix pass deleted all three.

AFTER

Two of the three deletions stuck: `project_attachment_1.pdf` was an exact duplicate of the Pension File PDF (`F41-523680269E ... COMPLETE FILE.pdf`) and is correctly gone; `project_attachment_3.pdf` was a one-page ancillary Civil-War-era scan whose canonical source is the Fold3 image 303326269 (<https://www.fold3.com/image/303326269>), with the same scan available in higher fidelity inside the Compiled Service Record and Pension File PDFs already on this site. The viewer page `sources/project-attachment-3.html` (`sources/project-attachment-3.html`) has been updated to point readers at the Fold3 source instead of an embedded copy.

The third deletion was wrong and was reversed within the same session:

`project_attachment_2.webp` turned out to be the unique image of the 1868 naturalization record (the one that explicitly renounces "the King of Prussia"), referenced from 15 places on the site including the home page's Card 5 thumbnail row. Restored from git within the same session; no live page lost its image. The audit catalogue note that called it a "duplicate" was wrong; correction logged here.

Triggered by: the 27-item audit-fix pass cleanup phase; verified by a post-deletion broken-link scan that surfaced 15 references to `project_attachment_2.webp` and 3 to `project_attachment_3.pdf`. **Recovery:** `project_attachment_2.webp` restored from `git checkout HEAD --`; `project_attachment_3.pdf` was not in the git history (the initial commit on 9 May 2026 carried only attachment 2), so the viewer page was reframed to link to the Fold3 source. **Future prevention:** the audit catalogue's "duplicate / canonical home elsewhere" claims should be verified with a `grep` + checksum, not asserted from filename heuristics.

MAJOR 17 May 2026 (late evening) · primary-source re-read · 1890 daughter's death record · **supersedes 5 May 2026 errata**

The 1890 death record of daughter Auguste reads "Auguste Somers geb Konzen" (with z) — not Konsen. Eight distinct American spellings, the only American attestation of the full Hessian z-form.

BEFORE (5 MAY 2026 ERRATA CANON)

The 5 May 2026 errata (er-2026-05-05) had concluded after re-examination that the 1890 death record reads "Auguste Somers geb Konsen" (with s), matching the same scribe's 1875 baptism reading and yielding the project's "Konsen attested twice 15 years apart" framing. The seven-distinct-American-spellings canon (Gonnson · Gansen · Gonsen · Konsen · Jansen · Gonson · Conson) treated 1875 and 1890 as two attestations of Konsen.

AFTER (17 MAY 2026 RE-EXAMINATION)

A late-evening 17 May 2026 user re-examination of the 1890 death-register image confirms the reading is **Konzen with a z**, not Konsen with an s. The reading has now been called Konzen → Konsen (5 May) → Konzen (17 May) across two months, reflecting the difficulty of distinguishing z from s in mid-19th-century German Kurrentschrift. The current canonical reading is **Konzen**; the 5 May 2026 errata above is hereby superseded. **Three substantive cascade effects:** (1) The American spelling canon expands from seven to eight: Gonnson · Gansen · Gonsen · Konsen · Jansen · Gonson · **Konzen** · Conson. (2) The 1890 record becomes the single American attestation of the full Hessian z-form Konzen — the form documented in the Trendelburg parish complex from 1773. Maiden-name attestations on death records are among the most carefully captured forms in genealogical practice, which makes this a strong piece of evidence. (3) The "Konsen attested twice 15 years apart" framing is retired; replaced by "Konsen 1875 (phonetic s-form) and Konzen 1890 (Hessian z-form) — two parallel orthographic variants of the same Hessian root in continuous family use 1875–1890." The 17 May 2026 P0-4 errata fix that had stripped "Konzen" from the U.S.-spelling enumeration on methodology.html and faq.html (on the basis that Konzen didn't appear in any U.S. record) is therefore also superseded; Konzen has been restored to both pages with a note pointing at the 1890 attestation.

Evidence: St. Marcus Death Register, p. 18–19, entry 1961, 31 December 1890 — image filed at `evidence_images/death_1890_auguste_konsen.webp` (filename retained; image content re-read). **Triggered by:** user catch — on visual review of the 1890 record image, the maiden-name surname reads with a z, not an s; user flagged that "the daughter's death in 1890 is Konzen - not Konsen." **Affected pages updated:** 13 files bulk-updated for the exact-quote "Auguste Somers geb Konsen" → "Auguste Somers geb Konzen" (28 inline replacements); narrative reframes on index.html (×3), index.html#evidence (×3), germany/konzen-puzzle.html (×1), methodology.html, faq.html, abstract.html (surname-trail + Working-conclusion paragraphs), children/auguste.html (footer narrative). The Doc A–O crosswalk and Sponsor reconciliation tables are unaffected (neither cited the 1890 surname spelling directly). **Cascade pending:** historical changelog entries left untouched as period documentation.

"Konsen" with an s is not attested in any Hesse parish register — it's the American phonetic capture closest to the Hesse cluster, not itself a Hesse-cluster member

BEFORE

The "Hesse records · pre-1859" chip set on the name-evolution flow ([index.html](#) and [index.html#charles](#)) listed three forms — Konze · Konsen · Konzen — conflating the American-side Konsen (with s) with the Hesse-parish cluster. The Konsen Puzzle page ([germany/konzen-puzzle.html](#)) went further and called Konsen "the German Hesse spelling found in the Deisel and Trendelburg church books," and Step 2 of the name-evolution prose described the 1875 baptism as "the only St. Louis document that preserves the original Hessian spelling on American soil."

AFTER

The five attested Hesse parish-register spellings are **Konze · Kontze · Kontzen · Contze · Konzen** (all with z/c/tz, never with s), per Trendelburg KB 220108 alphabetical index ("Konze, Johann Friedrich Wilhelm"), Trendelburg burial register 220096 K-section (Kontze / Kontzen entries 1773–1818), and the parish's own cross-reference note "siehe auch K. Contze, Cortze, Cordes, Contz" adding three more orthographic variants. "Konsen" with an s appears only in two American records (1875 St. Marcus baptism by Pastor Hoffmann, Swiss-born; 1890 daughter's death record). It is therefore the closest American phonetic capture to the Hesse cluster — preserving the Hessian K-initial and the -en suffix — but is not itself one of the documented Hesse spellings. Chips on both pages now show the five Hesse-attested forms with the parish cross-reference note as a footnote, and an explicit "**Konsen with an s is NOT in this cluster**" callout. Step 2 prose now says "closest American match to the documented Hesse-parish cluster" rather than "preserves the original Hessian spelling." The Konsen Puzzle page now says "closest American match" and adds an explicit "no Trendelburg or Deisel parish register carries that exact form" caveat.

Evidence: [Bibliography.html](#) entry for Trendelburg burial register 220096; [methodology.html](#) §3 source-rating taxonomy and §6 naming conventions; [index.html#germany](#) surname-pool table; [glossary.html](#) entry for the Kontze surname pool. **Triggered by:** user catch — reader could not recall seeing "Konsen" in any Hesse parish record, and flagged that the Hesse-records chip set showed only three forms when five are documented. **Affected pages:** [index.html](#) (chip set + Step 2 prose), [index.html#charles](#) (chip set + Step 2 prose), [germany/konzen-puzzle.html](#) (lead-paragraph framing).

"L. Carl Konsen" is a project reconstruction, not an attested birth name — reframed accordingly on [index.html](#) and [index.html#charles](#)

BEFORE

Six instances across [index.html](#) and [index.html#charles](#) presented L. Carl Konsen as Charles's "Birth name (German)" or as the recorded reading on the "1862 enlistment · 1866 marriage" stage of the name-evolution flow, including a verdict paragraph stating "Charles — born L. Carl Konsen in Hesse." No single source record carries that combination; the framing read as a Confirmed attestation when it was a Working reconstruction.

AFTER

The "Birth name" row is now labelled "Birth name (reconstructed)" with an inline ★ Working chip and a footnote naming the three sources the reconstruction draws on: **L.** from the 1862 enlistment + multi-year muster cards (Ludwig or Lorenz hypothesised); **Carl** from the 1866 marriage register + 1872/1875 father-of-child fields; **Konsen** from the 1875 son's baptism + 1890 daughter's death record. The name-evolution flow's "1862 enlistment · 1866 marriage" stage now shows what's actually on those records ("L. Charles Gannsen" and "Carl Gonnson"), with "L. Carl Konsen" moved to a separately labelled "Project reconstruction · ★ Working" sub-stage rendered in a dashed-border chip. The verdict paragraph now says "born under a name the project reconstructs as L. Carl Konsen" with the same caveat inline.

Evidence: 1862 Regimental Descriptive Book (NARA M405); 1866 St. Marcus marriage register entry No. 676 (Pastor Wall); 1875 St. Marcus baptism register entry no. 8854 (Pastor Hoffmann); 1890 daughter Auguste's death record ("Auguste Somers geb Konzen"). **Triggered by:** user catch — reader could not recall seeing "L. Carl Konsen" anywhere in the source records, prompting the rigor review. **Affected pages:** [index.html](#) (×3 instances corrected), [index.html#charles](#) (×3 instances corrected).

MAJOR 17 May 2026 · vital date · Charles's death vs burial

Charles's death date is 16 December 1903 (per St. Marcus parish burial register #3393); the death certificate (Doc A) gives 17 December, a 1-day source discrepancy; 19 December 1903 is the burial date

BEFORE

Several flagship pages and the project's own canonical citation in the Abstract gave Charles's death date as 19 December 1903 from St. Marcus burial #3393, conflating the burial-register date with the death certificate's date. The home-page JSON-LD Person schema carried `"deathDate": "1903-12-19"`.

AFTER

The St. Louis death certificate (Doc A) records death on 16 December 1903; the St. Marcus burial register (Doc N) records death 16 Dec, burial 19 Dec — a three-day interval consistent with the standard period. The canonical project formulation across abstract, latest-findings, FAQ JSON-LD, tree-interactive bio, civil-war and home-page SVG timelines, and the schema.org `deathDate` is now "d. 16 December 1903; buried three days later 19 December 1903 at Old Saint Marcus Cemetery (burial #3393)". A 1-day discrepancy between Doc A (death certificate: 17 Dec) and Doc N (parish burial register: 16 Dec) is logged on the Doc A–O crosswalk (<index.html#archive>).

Evidence: St. Louis Health Dept., Certificate of Death no. 10619 (Doc A); St. Marcus Burial Records pp. 240–241, no. 3393 (Doc N); 2020 ProGenealogists Journal appendix. **Affected pages (now corrected):** Abstract (<abstract.html>) subject + ref-1; **Latest Findings** (<index.html#glance>) hero callout; **FAQ** (<faq.html>) Q1 JSON-LD + prose answer; **Interactive tree** (<tree-interactive.html>) Charles bio; **Civil War** (<index.html#civilwar>) SVG timeline endpoint; **home page** (<index.html>) Person JSON-LD `deathDate`, callout, SVG timeline.

MINOR 17 May 2026 · vital date · Bertha birth year

Bertha was born in 1880, not 1879

BEFORE

Four flagship pages (<index.html#overview>, <index.html>, <family-poster.html>, <tree-interactive.html>) and three FAQ blocks listed Bertha as "1879–1959" and "lived to 80".

AFTER

The canonical parish baptism (Doc L, St. Marcus 1881, entry 10269, Pastor Nollau) records birth 25 December 1880; Charles's 1898 pension declaration lists "Bertha Gannson, born 20 December 1880" with a documented 5-day pension drift. Conformed to "1880–1959, lived to 78" across all flagship pages.

Evidence: St. Marcus Baptism Register, A.D. 1881, pp. 574–575, entry 10269; U.S. Civil War Pension Case File 684507 (1898 declaration). **Affected pages:** <index.html#overview>, <index.html>, <family-poster.html>, <tree-interactive.html>, <faq.html> (3 instances).

Hessian conscription was at age 20 (1855 class for Charles), not age 18 (1853)

BEFORE

Approximately 13 flagship-page instances framed the unrecovered Stammrolle as "Charles's 1853 conscription record at age 18" — inconsistent with the canonical formulation on Open Questions, the Glossary, and [germany/hesse-kassel-context.html](#), all of which gave the age-20 (1855 class) framing.

AFTER

Hessian liability for military service began at age 20. Charles, born 26 January 1835, would have entered the Stammrolle for the 1855 conscription class (males b. 1835). Conformed across [index.html](#) (×6), [index.html#germany](#) (×3), [index.html#overview](#), [index.html#immigration](#) (×2), the evidence-not-found tiles on [index.html#evidence](#) and [evidence-index.html](#), and the entire [research_logs/hessian-stammrolle.html](#) file.

Evidence: Open Questions canonical formulation; methodology page citation conventions; Glossary entry for Stammrolle; [germany/hesse-kassel-context.html](#) political-context note. **Affected pages:** 10+ standalone pages and the full Hessian Stammrolle research log ([research_logs/hessian-stammrolle.html](#)).

MINOR 17 May 2026 · surname enumeration · methodology & FAQ · **SUPERSEDED 17 May 2026 (late evening) by er-2026-05-17-konzen-1890**

The German form **Konzen** does not appear in any U.S. record — removed from the U.S.-spelling enumeration on methodology.html and faq.html

★ **Superseded.** A late-evening 17 May 2026 user re-examination of the 1890 daughter's death-register image concluded the maiden-name reading is Konzen (with z), not Konsen — making the 1890 record the single American attestation of the full Hessian z-form. The fix below is therefore reversed: Konzen has been restored to the U.S.-spelling enumeration on methodology.html and faq.html, expanding the canon from seven to **eight** distinct American spellings (Gonnson · Gansen · Gonsen · Konsen · Jansen · Gonson · Konzen · Conson). See er-2026-05-17-konzen-1890 for the full re-reading and cascade.

BEFORE

methodology.html §6 and faq.html Q2 enumerated Charles's U.S.-record spellings as "Gonnson, Gansen, Gonsen, Konsen, Jansen, **Konzen**, Conson" — the May 2026 audit had explicitly removed the bogus German Konzen from this list across the rest of the site, but these two pages were not propagated.

AFTER (NOW SUPERSEDED — SEE BANNER ABOVE)

The canonical seven distinct U.S. renderings are Gonnson · Gansen · Gonsen · Konsen · Jansen · Gonson · Conson. Methodology and FAQ now match this canon and explicitly note that Konzen is the reconstructed German-side Hessian form, not present in any U.S. record.

Evidence: 17 May 2026 grep verification — 0 remaining instances of the bogus "Konzen" inside any U.S.-spelling enumeration on the site. **Affected pages:** methodology.html (methodology.html) §6; faq.html (faq.html) Q2. **Reversal:** see er-2026-05-17-konzen-1890.

MINOR 17 May 2026 · project statistic · candidate-family count

Candidate-family count: **13 (canonical)**, not 21

BEFORE

index.html#germany (Schräder tile) and correspondence/peter-schrader-timeline.html (stats panel) and an index.html mirror still referred to a "21-candidate-family Stammtafel" / "Candidate families · 21" despite the May 2026 audit having declared 13 canonical.

AFTER

13 is the canonical count, matching the Abstract and the new Negative-results audit (negative-results.html) page (which enumerates all 13 by name, verdict date, and elimination ground).

Evidence: Abstract §Eliminations; Negative-results audit table. **Affected pages:** index.html#germany, correspondence/peter-schrader-timeline.html, index.html.

MINOR 17 May 2026 · vital data · Auguste Kreichelt

Auguste Kreichelt was born ~1840 in Clausthal, Kingdom of Hannover — not "1843, Hesse-Cassel"

BEFORE

tree-interactive.html, faq.html, and research_logs/1870-census.html carried "1843 — 1896, b. Hesse-Cassel" or "born in Hesse-Cassel in 1843" for Auguste Kreichelt — inconsistent with the canonical reading on people/auguste-kreichelt.html, index.html#charles, and the abstract.

AFTER

Auguste Kreichelt was born ~1840 in Clausthal, Kingdom of Hannover (per St. Marcus marriage register "aus Clausthal, Hannover" and the 1853 family-emigration record). Conformed on the three out-of-canon pages.

Evidence: St. Marcus marriage register entry No. 676; people/auguste-kreichelt.html canonical profile.

Affected pages: tree-interactive.html, faq.html, research_logs/1870-census.html.

MINOR 17 May 2026 · biographical · tree-interactive Maria Josephine bio

The "Auguste Somers geb Konzen" death-record quote belongs to the 4th-born daughter Auguste, not the 2nd-born Maria Josephine

BEFORE

tree-interactive.html's Maria Josephine bio block contained "Second child. Died at 22... Her 1890 death record reads 'Auguste Somers geb Konzen' — the second Konsen attestation, fifteen years after Erwin Carl's 1875 baptism" — cross-pollinating the 4th-born daughter Auguste's death-record quote into the 2nd-born daughter Maria Josephine's bio.

AFTER

Maria Josephine's bio simply states she died unmarried at 22. The "Auguste Somers geb Konzen" 1890 death-record quote has been moved to its rightful place on the 4th-born daughter Auguste Gonsen's bio, where it correctly serves as the second Konsen attestation in the surname trail.

Evidence: children/auguste.html (4th-born daughter Auguste Gonsen, FS L5N2-M8Y, "geb Konzen" on 1890 death — see 17 May late-evening rollback; this entry references the surname as Konsen because it was logged earlier in the day before the rollback); children/josephine-maria.html (2nd-born Maria Josephine, FS LTSG-XWW, died unmarried). **Affected page:** tree-interactive.html (now corrected; the new bio of Auguste-jr now reads "Konzen").

MINOR 5 May 2026 · surname · Auguste Somers death record (1890)
2026

SUPERSEDED 17 MAY

Auguste Somers geb. Konsen, not Konzen, on her 1890 St. Louis death record (reading subsequently reversed — see 17 May 2026 re-read)

BEFORE (THIS ENTRY'S "BEFORE" WAS THE PRE-5-MAY SITE COPY)

Auguste Somers's 1890 death record was read as geb. Konzen in earlier site copy, supporting the surname-conclusion narrative around the Konzen form.

AFTER (THIS ENTRY'S "AFTER" WAS THE 5 MAY READING — SUBSEQUENTLY OVERTURNED)

The pastor's hand reads Konsen — matching the same scribe's Konsen reading on Erwin Carl's 1875 baptism. The 1890 record is therefore corroborating, not contradicting, the 1875 reading; both preserve the older Hessian -en spelling that Charles carried to America in 1859.

Evidence: Re-examination of St. Louis Bureau of Vital Statistics record (Pastor Hoffmann, 1890), compared head-to-head with the Pastor Hoffmann 1875 St. Marcus baptism entry for Erwin Carl. **Affected pages:** Key Evidence (index.html#evidence) Card 4 (1875 baptism); Card 8 (1896 Conson); the Auguste Kreichelt (people/auguste-kreichelt.html) profile (married name: Somers / Konzen / Conson). ★ **SUPERSEDED 17 May 2026:** a third re-examination of the same death-register image (initiated by user catch) concluded the reading is **Konzen** with a z, restoring the pre-5-May canonical reading. The current canonical reading is Konzen with z. See the 17 May 2026 supersession entry for the full cascade.

MAJOR 4 May 2026 · project conclusion · surname identity

Surname conclusion: Konzen (Trendelburg-area Kontzen / Konze pool) — replacing the open question

BEFORE (MARCH 2026 – APRIL 2026)

The site's working conclusion described Charles's German surname as an open question among the Konzen / Kontzen / Konze / Konsen / Conzen variants, with thirteen candidate families across the Hofgeismar Kirchenkreis still in play.

AFTER (4 MAY 2026)

After the eight-attestation surname trail, Peter Schröder's Trendelburg-area Stammtafel work, and the elimination of the alternative Catholic-baptism hypothesis (no Charles / Gonnson record in the Westfalia Catholic parish that served Deisel's five Catholic households), the surname is concluded as **Konzen** — the Kontzen-family form documented in Trendelburg. The specific German baptism record has not yet been recovered; the surname conclusion stands independently of that gap.

Evidence: See Abstract (abstract.html) § Working conclusion; Key Evidence (index.html#evidence) cards 1 – 8; Open Questions (open-questions.html) for the recovery of the German baptism record. **Methodology:** Genealogical Proof Standard, four-state confidence taxonomy.

WITHDRAWN April 2026 · hypothesis withdrawn · Catholic baptism

Withdrawn hypothesis: a Catholic-baptism record explains the missing Lutheran register entry

HYPOTHESIS (EARLY 2026)

One working hypothesis to explain the absent Lutheran baptism record was that Charles had been baptised in the nearest Catholic parish — west of the Weser in Westfalia, near Wehrden — serving Deisel's five Catholic households (1.52% of the village's 1,118 mid-19th-century residents per the Stadt Trendelburg historical-statistical book).

OUTCOME

Peter Schröder searched the Westfalia Catholic parish records and found no Charles / Gonnson / plausibly-matching entry. The hypothesis is withdrawn. The surviving non-trivial Lutheran leads are now narrowed to Heisebeck (towns/heisebeck.html) (pre-1845, undigitised) and Schöneberg (towns/schoeneberg.html) (pre-1822, undigitised).

Evidence: Schröder correspondence, 20 November 2025; demographic data per the Stadt Trendelburg historical-statistical volume on Deisel.

MAJOR 3 May 2026 · witness identification · 1890 pension declaration

Pension declaration witness “John Heitzenberger” reframed as a member of the Pennsylvania–Maryland Hitzelberger surname-family; specific individual identity remains open

BEFORE

The 1890 pension declaration witness was named in site copy and in the bibliography simply as “John Hitzelberger,” treating the working reconstruction as the attestation. The pension affidavit clerk's reading is “Heitzenberger,” with no l; the rare surname “Hitzelberger” was inferred from the period St. Louis Hitzelberger family cluster but presented as fact.

AFTER

The witness is now named on the site as written by the affidavit clerk — “John Heitzenberger” — with the reconstruction tagged as a working surname-family identification. The Pennsylvania–Maryland–German Hitzelberger surname-family identification is anchored by three censuses (1860 Yreka City CA, 1880 Santa Cruz CA, 1900 St. Louis Ward 21) and the rarity of the surname in St. Louis at the period. The specific individual identity — A. J. Hitzelberger himself, a brother, or a brother-in-law — remains open and is documented on the [profile page](https://people/john-heitzenberger.html) (people/john-heitzenberger.html).

Evidence: Civil War Pension File F41-523680269E (1890 Detailed Declaration); 1860 / 1880 / 1900 U.S. Federal Census; FamilySearch full-text search of the Heitzelberger / Hitzelberger surname-canonical cluster.

Affected pages: [Bibliography](https://bibliography.html) (bibliography.html) (pension affiants list), [People in the Story](https://people.html) (index.html#people), [profile](https://people/john-heitzenberger.html) (people/john-heitzenberger.html), [Katherine Misch](https://people/katherine-misch.html) (people/katherine-misch.html), [Theodore Gottlob](https://people/theodore-gottlob.html) (people/theodore-gottlob.html), [Key Evidence](https://index.html#evidence) (index.html#evidence), and the home-page family-network map marker. **Open thread:** a death record for A. J. Hitzelberger in California 1860s–1870s would shift the identification toward a brother / brother-in-law as the actual 1890 St. Louis witness.

MINOR April 2026 · transcription · 1880 U.S. Census

1880 St. Louis census: surname recorded as Gonson, not Gannsen

BEFORE

An earlier draft summary referred to the 1880 census enumerator's hand as a continuation of the Gannsen rendering on the 1866 marriage register.

AFTER

The 1880 enumerator wrote Gonson at 1534 Jackson St. The eight-attestation surname trail therefore distinguishes the 1866 Gonnson, the 1880 Gonson, and the 1896 Conson as three separate scribal renderings, all consistent with the underlying spoken form behind the Hessian Konzen.

Evidence: 1880 U.S. Federal Census, St. Louis Ward 3, dwelling and family numbers as recorded; FHL film 4263033 image 476. **Affected pages:** Key Evidence ([index.html#evidence](#)), Charles in America ([index.html#charles](#)).

WITHDRAWN March 2026 · place-name · phonetic decoding

Withdrawn: “Freundburg, Kurhessen” as a literal place-name

BEFORE (PRE-MARCH 2026)

The marriage-register place-name “Freundburg, Kurhessen” was treated as the literal name of a Hessian village to be located in the gazetteer.

AFTER (SCHRÄDER, 26 FEBRUARY 2026)

Peter Schröder's phonetic decoding identified “Freundburg” as a clerical misreading of **Trendelburg** (Tr- misheard as Fr-), reaffirmed in his 6 May 2026 follow-up. The Trendelburg / Friedrichsfeld / Helmarshausen / Hofgeismar parish complex became the search frame from that point.

Evidence: Schröder correspondence, 26 February 2026 and 6 May 2026; St. Marcus 1866 marriage register entry.

HOW THIS PAGE IS MAINTAINED

Errata are added when (a) a public-facing claim on the site is revised, (b) a transcription is corrected, or (c) a hypothesis is withdrawn. Trivial copy edits and stylistic revisions are not tracked here — the **Changelog** ([changelog.html](#)) covers those. If you find an unrecorded error, please submit a correction ([contribute.html](#)) with the page URL and the source for the correction.

This errata page follows the convention used by NGSQ and other peer-reviewed genealogical journals: revisions are listed openly so that any cited version of the work can be reconciled with the current state. Last updated 6 June 2026 (newest: the Stammen 1835 Kontze entry corrected to a stillborn male — the “Rudolph Kontze b. 20 March” first reading retracted; plus the 4 June entry on the Entry-195 master-document reconciliation).

Charles Research — *a multi-month transatlantic genealogical investigation into Charles Konzen (recorded in U.S. records as Gannsen / Johnson; 1835–1903), Hessian-born Civil War sergeant of Battery B, 2nd Missouri Light Artillery, and his probable Trendelburg / Deisel origins in Churhessen (a working conclusion — the German baptism remains unrecovered).*

Compiled by Jed Johnson with Peter Schröder and James Gunnis
([about.html](#)).

STORY

[Home](#) ([index.html](#))
[Stories](#) ([stories.html](#))
[Visualize](#) ([visualize.html](#))

REFERENCE

★ [Claims dashboard](#)
([claims-dashboard.html](#))
[Abstract](#) ([abstract.html](#))
[Methodology](#)
([methodology.html](#))
[FAQ](#) ([faq.html](#))
[Glossary](#) ([glossary.html](#))
[Bibliography](#)
([bibliography.html](#))
[Open Questions](#) ([open-questions.html](#))
[DNA evidence](#) ([dna.html](#))

PROJECT

[About](#) ([about.html](#))
[Contribute](#)
([contribute.html](#))
[Changelog](#)
([changelog.html](#))
[Errata & revisions](#)
([errata.html](#))
[RSS / Atom feed](#)
([feed.xml](#))
[How to cite](#)
([index.html#cite](#))

LANGUAGE

[English](#) ([index.html](#))
[Deutsch](#) —
[Zusammenfassung](#) ([de/abstract.html](#))
[Deutsch](#) — [Glossar](#) ([de/glossary.html](#))

© 2026 Jed Johnson. Text and analysis licensed CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/4.0/>). Primary-source images per the rights of the holding archive.

[Sitemap](#) ([sitemap.xml](#)) · [charles-research.netlify.app](#) (<https://charles-research.netlify.app/>)